J.P.Morgan PAYMENTS

Treasury 2.0: Built for a New Era

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Foreword

For decades, corporate treasury has earned its reputation by protecting value - safeguarding cash, managing exposures, ensuring compliance. That mandate hasn't changed.

But the world around treasury is reconfiguring itself. Payments now move in seconds, markets shift in minutes, boards expect answers in hours, and artificial intelligence is no longer a future promise - it is a present-day reality. This is fundamentally redefining how decisions are made, risk is managed, and businesses operate.

Treasury must evolve accordingly. Next-generation treasury isn't just about doing the same things faster; it's about seeing sooner, deciding smarter, and acting in real time.

This report is our effort to map the journey from where most companies are today to where they must be tomorrow - with clear trends, practical frameworks, and real-world blueprints to help companies navigate complexity, embrace transformation, and build the next-generation corporate treasury.

Patricia Devine

Global Head of Corporate Sales

Tristan Attenborough

Global Head of Advisory

Varoon Mandhana

Global Head of Treasury Advisory

Nirav Kakariya

N.A. Lead Treasury Advisory

01

Compounding Convergence: Why Sequential Playbooks Are Obsolete

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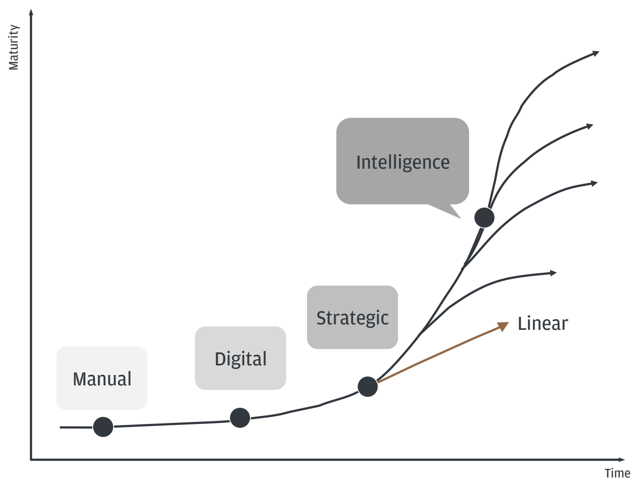
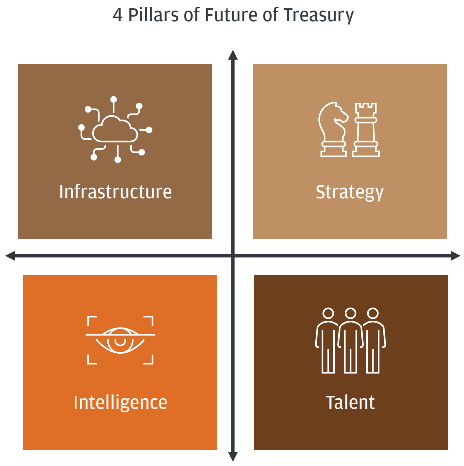
Treasury Transformation S-Curve

In last year's report (Link), we highlighted that the next wave of treasury transformation will follow an exponential curve driven by intelligent technologies. That view was directionally right but structurally incomplete. The shape of this curve, we now believe, will be driven not by technology alone, but by how CFOs and treasurers adapt and innovate across four foundational pillars — Infrastructure, Intelligence, Talent, and Strategy.

Treasury Transformation S-Curve

The Next Wave





Over the past year, a series of market shifts have stress-tested traditional business paradigms and exposed the limitations of legacy operating models:

- Tech capital spending reached ~1.8% of US GDP, rivaling the combined spend on the Manhattan Project, the Apollo Program, and the Interstate Highway System[1]
- Nearshoring momentum accelerated with 33% of US firms and 28% of EU firms actively restructuring supply chains[2]
- Global conflicts involved 78 countries beyond their borders — nearly 40% of the world[3]
- The private credit market reached historic scale, surpassing $3.5 trillion in AUM[4]
- AI capability surged — SWE-Bench performance jumping from 4.4% in 2023 to 100% in 2026[5]
- Bot attacks rose 59% year-over-year, while synthetic identities surged from 1.4% of overall fraud in 2024 to 11% in 2025[6]
- Cybercrime damages approached $500 billion annually — with AI-driven acceleration poised to add $100 billion or more[7]
- Tokenization of real-world assets expanded from $6 billion to $31 billion[8]

Taken together, the picture is one of a fundamentally different operating environment — one that demands a more deliberate, multi-dimensional approach to treasury strategy. This report digs into 13 transformative trends across the four strategic pillars that will define treasury management through 2026 and beyond.

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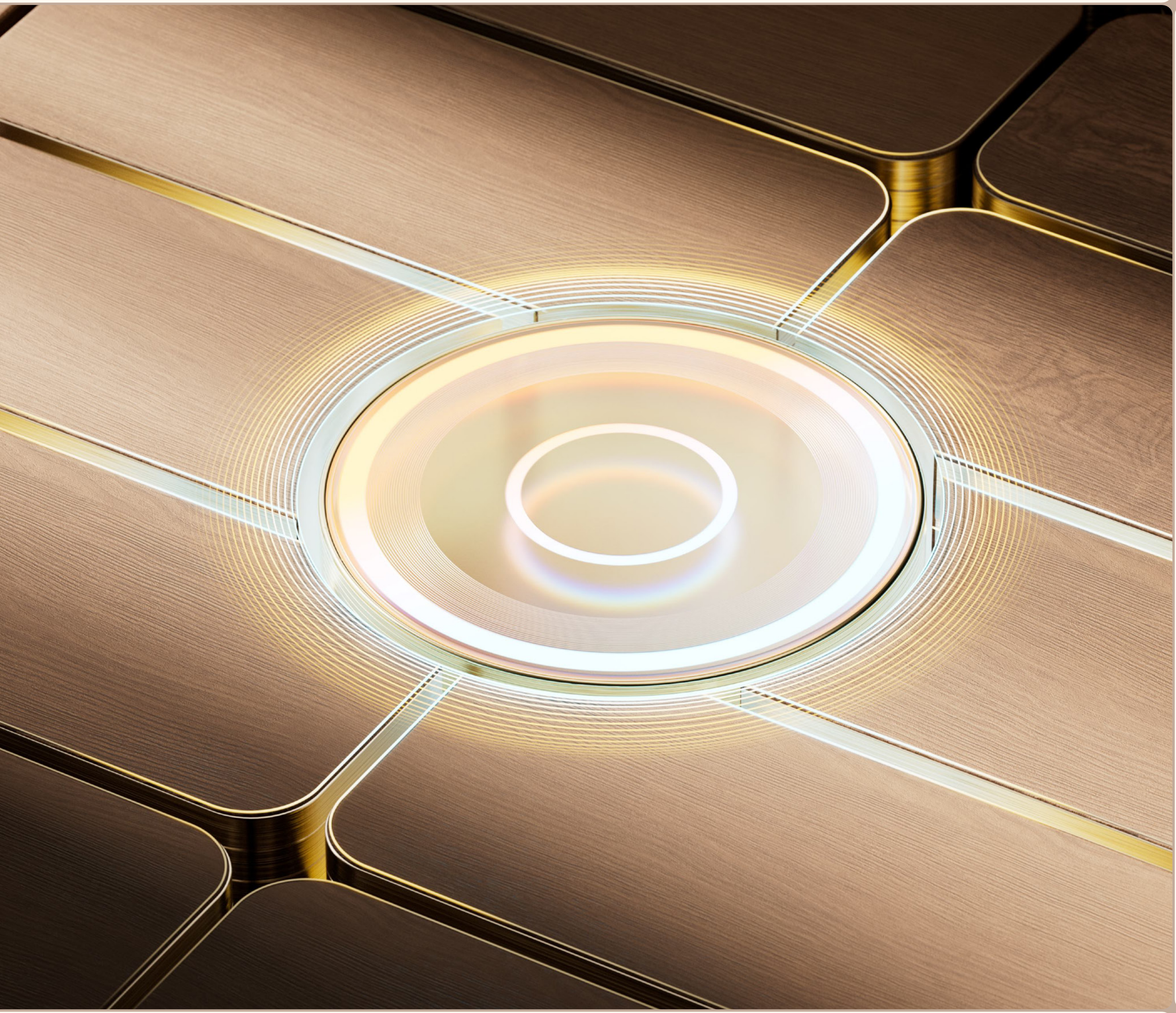
Key Trends Defining Next Generation Treasury

Infrastructure	The AI Adoption Paradox	\$30 - \$40 billion poured into enterprise AI yet 95% of organizations have nothing to show for it. The bottleneck is not an investment - it's the infrastructure[9]
	The End of the Monolith	Agent-native infrastructure is now table stakes. Legacy platforms that can't support agentic workflows will become the ceiling of treasury's AI ambitions
	No Single Rail Wins	With 300+ payment methods globally, the multi-rail reality is here. Treasuries that optimize for one rail accept avoidable trade-offs in cost, speed and resilience[10]
	Digital Currency: Past the Hype, Not Yet Past the Test	Stablecoins hit \$320 billion[11], tokenized assets surged to \$31 billion[8] - but large-scale commercial adoption remains constrained until compliance, accounting clarity, and market depth improves.
Intelligence	The Polycrisis is Permanent	Since 2001, compounding disruptions have erased - \$62 trillion in market capital. Sequential playbooks are obsolete - simultaneous shocks are the new operating reality[10]
	Regulation Everywhere All at Once	ISO 20022, Basel IV, MiCA, PSD3, DORA, the GENIUS Act - regulatory density across jurisdictions has reached a level where reactive compliance is a losing strategy. Foresight wins[10]
	Fraud is Outrunning the Defenses	AI-amplified attacks are projected to drive \$40 billion in losses by 2027. Deepfakes, synthetic identities, and autonomous phishing kits demand layered controls - not incremental patches[12]
Talent	AI can Assist - But Can't Yet Be Trusted	AI models are advancing rapidly, but production-grade accuracy thresholds required for treasury operations have yet to be achieved - human treasury judgement remains irreplaceable
	The Hollowing of the Middle	72% of employers face hiring difficulty, average treasury teams run on just ~12 FTEs, and the rush to cut entry-level roles may restrict leadership pipeline[13]
	The New Skill Stack	Domain expertise remains important. AI literacy, data fluency, and the ability to articulate treasury's strategic value emerging as desired treasury skills
Strategy	The In-House Bank Imperative	Fragmented banking relationships and decentralized liquidity are no longer just inefficient - they're a risk. The IHB journey moves from "nice-to-have" to operational necessity
	\$761 Billion Hiding in Plain Sight	The working capital gap between top and bottom quartile performers isn't closing - it's widening. Treasury holds the keys to unlock it.[10]
	Treasury's Seat at the Deal Table	With global M&A surging 42% to \$5.1 trillion in 2025, deals are growing larger and more complex - demanding earlier treasury involvement than ever before.[10, 14]

02

Infrastructure: Legacy Architecture Nullifying ROI



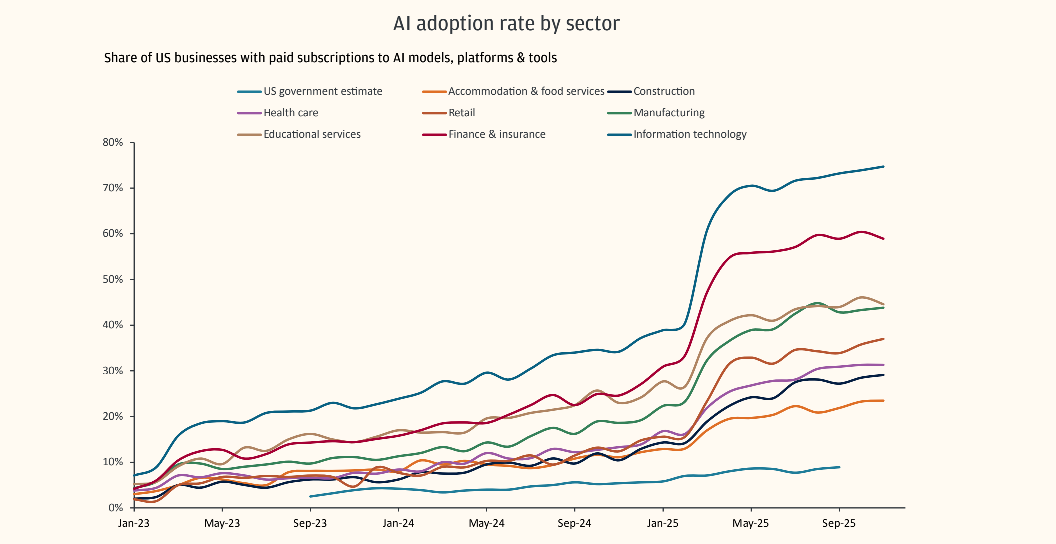
2A The AI Adoption Paradox

Before we address architecture, it's worth taking an honest look at where we are.

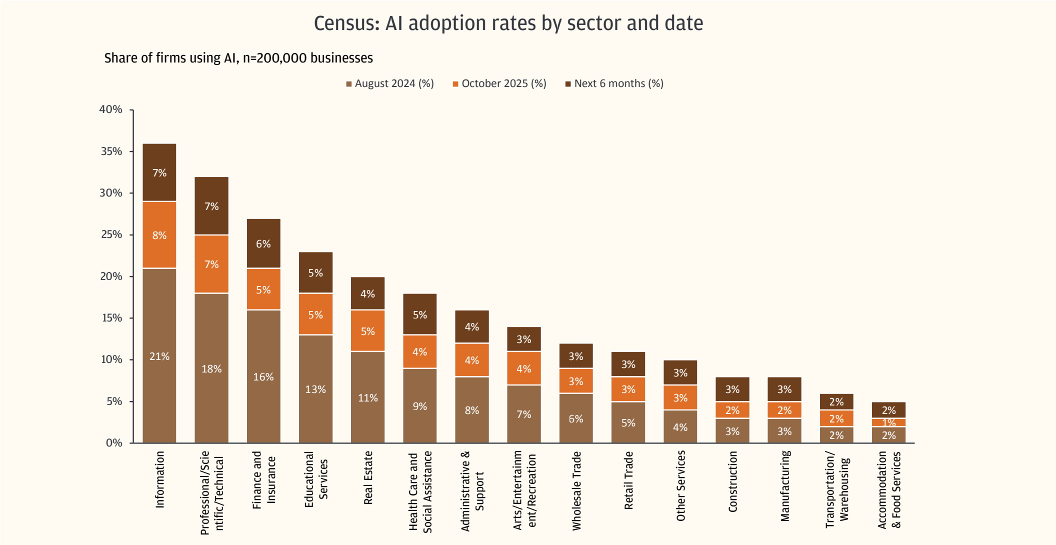
Enterprise AI usage is scaling — and with deeper workflow integration than before. ChatGPT message volume grew 8x, and API reasoning token consumption per organization increased 320x year-over-year[15], demonstrating not just broader adoption, but significantly deeper usage intensity.

But here's the catch — almost none of that usage is showing up in finance. It's concentrated in software development, technology, professional services, and knowledge work. Treasury remains largely on the outside looking in.

Subscription of paid AI models by sector



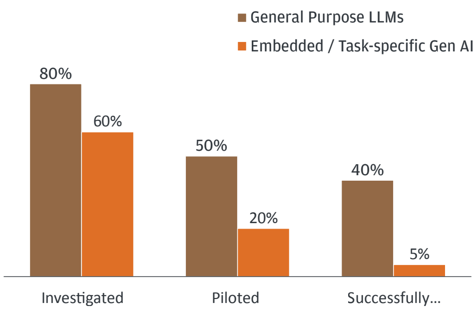
Subscription of paid AI models by Sector



Source: J.P. Morgan Eye on the Market - Smothering Heights

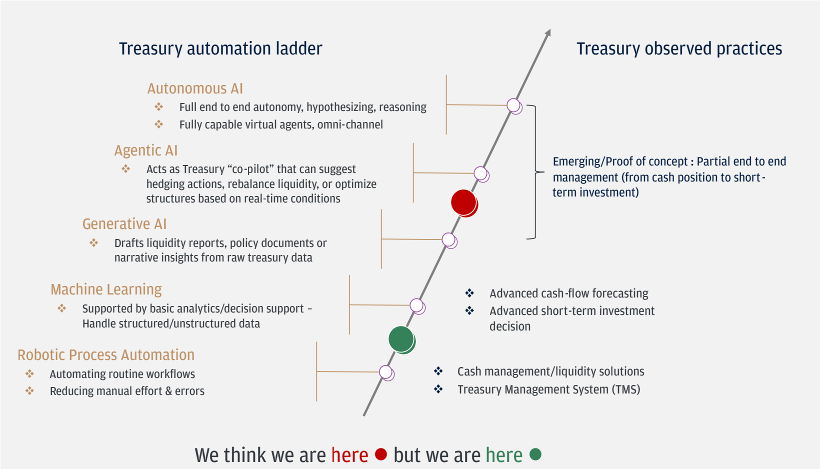
A July 2025 MIT study found that despite $30-$40 billion in enterprise AI investment, 95% of organizations are seeing no business return and less than 5% of organizations have successfully implemented task-specific AI projects that extend beyond general-purpose LLMs[9]. Treasury and finance are no exception – the majority of adoption remains somewhere between RPA and machine learning: slightly smarter dashboards, chatbots that can summarize a bank statement but can't execute a hedge.

AI Successful Project Deployment Rates



Source: State of AI in Business 2025 - MIT NANDA;
J.P. Morgan Payments Global Advisory Research

AI in Corporate Treasury Exists Today but Has Not Reached Its Full Potential



A few common themes often come up in these discussions like talent gap or inadequate ROI. We do not believe this is the primary explanation. The real bottleneck is infrastructure – and the numbers speak for themselves.

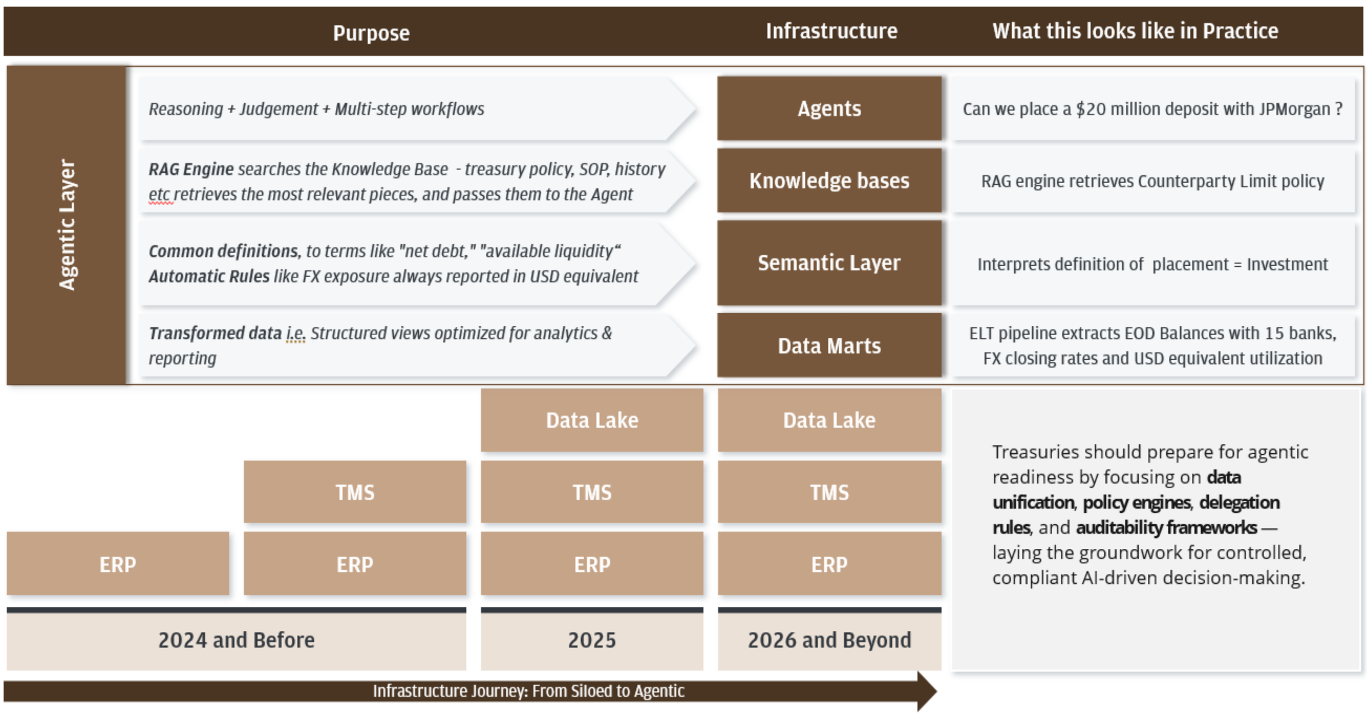
Infrastructure	The Number	Observation
Median TMS age before replacement	10 years[16]	Legacy on-premises systems often exceed 12-15 years. The rip-and-replace cost often becomes prohibitive.
Treasury tech spend as % revenue	0.01%-0.03%	Total finance receives ~1% [17] of org revenue. Enterprise IT gets 6%-8%[18, 19]. Treasury receives a fraction of the finance budget despite managing 100% of the company's liquidity.
Treasury FTEs per legal entity	1 per 12 entities	A Fortune 500 treasury with 100-200 legal entities runs on ~12 people[20]. That ratio hasn't changed in a decade.

Legacy infrastructure, low tech budgets and a skeleton team, limits treasury ability to successfully deploy and scale AI solutions. Everything that follows is about closing the gap.

2B Agent-Native Infrastructure Becomes Table Stakes

TMS implementations and ERP cloud migrations have consumed treasury's bandwidth over the last few years. Some organizations have also taken a strategic approach to enterprise and treasury data management through data lake buildouts. However, many of the legacy treasury platforms are not built for agentic workflows and would require investment in an additional "AI Intelligence layer" before they could realistically implement scalable AI initiatives.

Agent-native Infrastructure Becomes Table Stakes

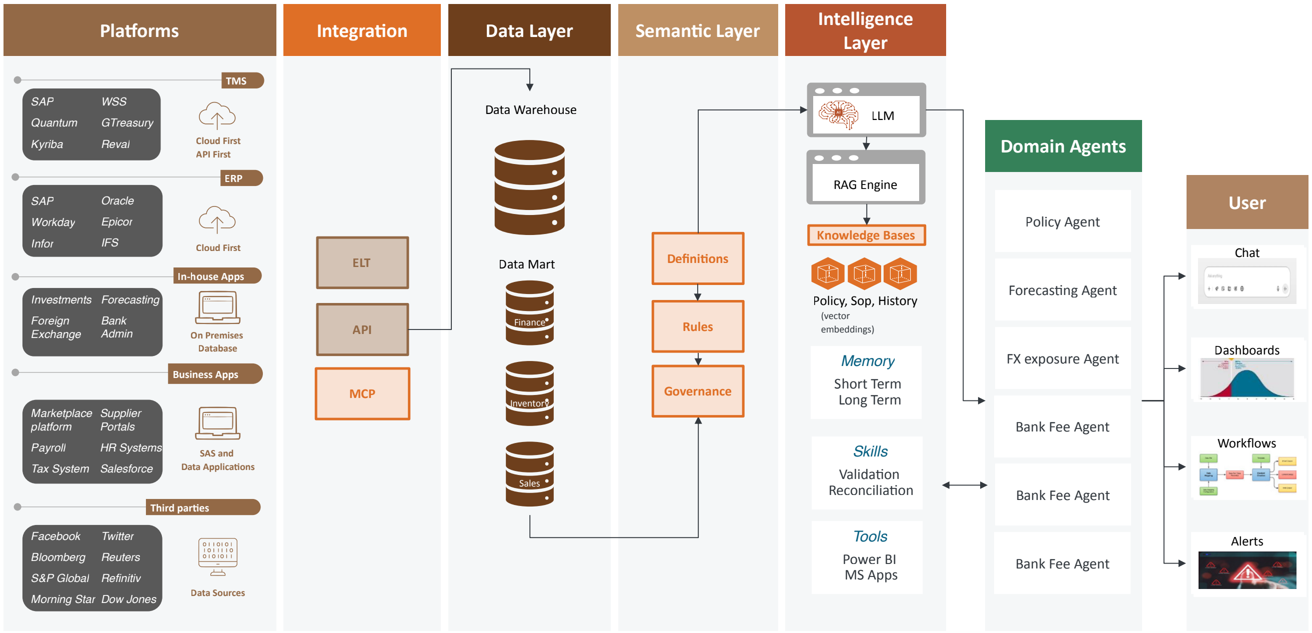


We sat down with our internal engineering and data teams, as well as clients—digging into AI projects firsthand—to get a clearer picture of what corporate treasurers actually need to do next. Treasury leaders don't need to become engineers, however, they must understand the building blocks well enough to ask the right questions and avoid expensive dead ends.

Architecture Overview

- **Source Systems:** The foundation starts with core transactional systems. The TMS handles cash, liquidity, FX, and bank connectivity, while the ERP manages the general ledger, AP/AR, and financial reporting. These are supplemented by direct Banking Partner feeds and Market Data providers.
- **Integration Layer:** An API Gateway, ETL/ELT pipelines, and real-time streaming services orchestrate the movement of data from source systems into the data platform, ensuring both batch and real-time data availability.
- **Data Platform:** The Data Lake stores raw and historical data (including unstructured documents), while the Data Marts provide structured, aggregated views optimized for analytics and KPI tracking.
- **Semantic Layer:** This critical layer sits between data and consumers, providing a unified data model with consistent business definitions, governed metric calculations, and standardized terminology — ensuring everyone speaks the same "data language."
- **AI & Intelligence Layer:** The LLM layer powers natural language understanding and generation. The Knowledge Base stores treasury policies, SOPs, and regulatory guidelines, indexed as vector embeddings for semantic retrieval. The RAG Engine retrieves relevant context from the Knowledge Base to ground the LLM's responses.
- **AI Agents:** These are specialized autonomous modules (cash forecasting, risk analysis, compliance, anomaly detection) that leverage both the Semantic Layer and the LLM to execute domain-specific tasks.
- **User Interface & Consumption:** End users interact through dashboards, a conversational AI chatbot, automated alerts, and workflow automation — all powered by the intelligence layer beneath.

Technology Landscape



From Architecture to Action: What Treasuries Can Plan Now

The architecture above represents the target state – but treasuries don't need to wait for full implementation to start making progress. There are four areas where planning can begin today, regardless of where you are on your TMS or ERP journey:

Data Visibility & Unification
You cannot automate what you cannot predict, and you cannot predict what you cannot see. Treasuries should work toward building a real-time, unified view of cash positions, exposures, and counterparty activity – across entities, currencies, and banking partners.

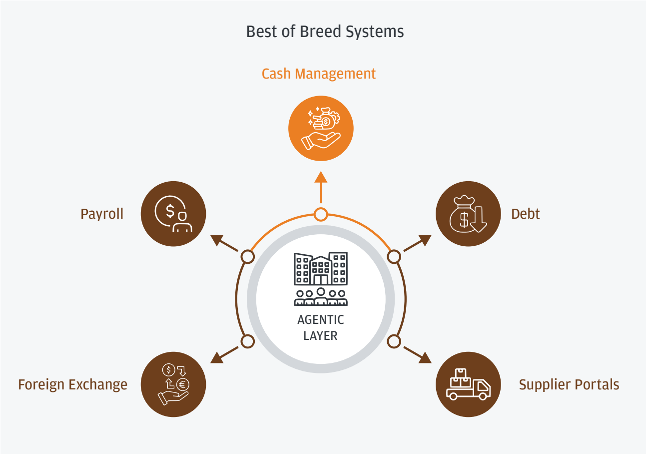
Policy Engines
An AI layer without encoded rules creates uncontrolled risk. Treasuries should begin mapping their operating rules – risk limits, counterparty thresholds, regulatory constraints – that future agents can follow.

Agentic Delegation
Not every decision should be delegated, and not every decision requires a human. Treasuries should start defining what an agent can initiate on its own, what it must flag, and what it must escalate for approval.

Auditability Framework
Without audit trails, treasuries face regulatory risk and an inability to diagnose failures. Every agent-initiated decision should produce a traceable record – what was decided, why, what data informed it, and who authorized it. Defining that record structure keeping SOX compliance in mind can start now.

This new Agentic AI infrastructure could have profound implications for treasury operating models and we want to highlight a few of the most significant:

Payment Acceptance



A. End of Monoliths

Integration complexities, budget constraints and data management challenges have often held back companies on monolithic platforms, despite these platforms not offering much flexibility with last-mile customizations, speed, or user experience.

In recent years, larger treasuries have pivoted toward best-of-breed platforms for different treasury functions, and heavily invested in backend integrations and treasury data lakes to stitch things together into a single reporting layer. The new AI layer is likely to push this approach further and standards like APIs, Model Context Protocol (MCP), and CLI-based tooling will continue to reduce integration complexity.

B. Rise of Treasury Custom Workflows

In recent years, TMS and ERP migration to cloud and SaaS models has made last-mile automation and workflow customizations more difficult for corporate treasuries to configure.

However, something fundamental has shifted in the software development life cycle (SDLC) – and most treasurers haven't yet connected the dots. AI coding agents – software systems that can independently write, test, and deploy production-grade applications from a simple natural-language prompt – are improving at a pace that has no modern precedent.

SDLC Phase	Productivity Gain
Concept & Design	**15–25%**[21]
Build & Test	**25–40%**[21]
Documentation & Reporting	**71.9%** find AI most valuable here[22]
Testing & QA	**65.6%** find AI most valuable here[22]
Code Generation	**64.1%** find AI most valuable here[22]

Treasury Custom Workflows

1. Forecasting Worksheets
2. Bank Administration
3. Dividend Tracker
4. FX Request Workflows
5. Funding Request
6. Banking Wallet Analyzer

To be clear: these aren't chatbots. They are autonomous software engineers that can take a sentence like "build me a dashboard that pulls our bank balances from five banks, reconciles them against our ERP ledger, and flags variances above $50,000" – and deliver a working application in hours, not months. What once required a six-month vendor engagement, a dedicated IT team, and a six-figure budget can now, in many cases, be prototyped in a day and deployed in a week.

This will allow treasuries to capture and automate a number of last-mile processes that have not made it to a TMS or ERP system historically due to resource constraints.

The TMS Isn't Irrelevant – But Its Role Changes. To be clear, this argument is not that the TMS disappears. Bank connectivity, SWIFT messaging, payment file generation, core accounting integration, and regulatory infrastructure will continue to require robust, certified, industrial-grade platforms. The TMS will remain the plumbing.

But the workflow layer – the part of treasury technology that defines how a treasurer interacts with data, makes decisions, and manages exceptions – is the layer that AI coding agents will increasingly own. Think of it like a car. The TMS is the engine – it stays. But the dashboard, the navigation, the driver-assist features? That's the AI-built workflow layer. And increasingly, it's going to be custom, dynamic, and defined by the treasurer – not the vendor.

C. Treasury Use-Case Boom – From Cautious Pilots to the Art of the Possible

AI adoption in treasury and finance has not been as fast as in other business functions – but it has picked up pace meaningfully over the last year. The diagram highlights examples of publicly disclosed AI adoption by S&P 500 companies, and the trajectory it reveals is striking: what began as scattered experiments in 2023 has become a broad-based wave of deployment by Q1 2026.

AI Adoption in Treasury and Finance Processes

Illustrative & Non-exhaustive

	2023	2024	2025	1Q2026
AP, Procurement & Invoicing	**Trimble**[23] *Automatic invoicing*			**Adobe**[24] *Contract review*
AR, Credit & Reconciliation	**ResMed**[25] *Cash Application*	**Microsoft**[26] *AR Reconciliation*	**Velocity Clinical Research**[27] *Agentic Payment reconcile* **HP**[28] *Dispute resolution*	
FP&A, Forecasting & Financial Reporting	**ASML**[29] *Automated forecasting*	**Amazon**[30] *Fraud & forecasting*	**Amazon**[31] *Financial insights* **PwC**[32] *Streamline Reporting*	
Treasury & Cash Management	**Amazon**[33] *Dynamic Cash Positioning*		**American Airlines**[34] *Collateral Management*	**Unilever**[35] *Agentic Finance workflow*
Supply chain, Operations & Logistics	**Walmart**[36] *Inventory optimization* **UPS**[37] *Automated Facility routing*		**Unilever**[38] *Supply chain & seasonality* **Amazon**[39] *Fulfilment Robotics* **United Health Group**[40] *Cost reduction*	**Coca-Cola**[41] *Freight optimization* **FedEx**[42] *Robotic trailer unloading*
AI Chatbots and Virtual Assistants	**Schneider Electric**[43] *Finance advisor*	**Procter & Gamble**[44] *Task automation* **S&P Global**[45] *Employee chatbot*	**Apple**[46] *Employee chatbot*	**AstraZeneca**[47] *Regulatory drafting* **Airbnb**[48] *Customer Agent*
Finance Transformation & Governance		**Meta**[49] *Finance ML Efficiency* **Coca-Cola**[50] *Enterprise Partnership*	**Walmart**[51] *Operations agent* **AT&T**[52] *Agentic CFO workflows* **Johnson & Johnson**[53] *Enterprise value creation*	**Pepsico**[54] *Digital twin operation*

The next wave of AI in treasury is poised to be fundamentally different. It is moving beyond simple LLM-powered chat interfaces – "ask a question, get an answer" – toward handling complex, multi-step workflows that combine data retrieval, analysis, judgment, and action in a single orchestrated flow. This AI use-case framework presented below maps what the future might look like across the full breadth of key treasury functions and complexity levels. The shift from conversational AI to agentic AI is the defining transition for treasury in 2026 and beyond.

AI Use Cases Across Treasury Functions

	Low Complexity		High Complexity
Bank Admin	• Bank Fees Verification • FBAR Reporting • TMS Testing • Bank Letters	• User De-activations • Signatory Reviews	• Banking Strategy
Cash & Liquidity	• Payment Pre-advices • LC Doc Checks • Liquidity Reporting • Reconciliation • Payment Validation • Variance Analysis • Cash Positioning	• Spend File Analysis • Netting • Cash Forecasting	• Liquidity Structure Recommendations • Funding Strategy • Investment Recommendations
Risk Management	• Regulatory Intelligence • Reg Reporting • Payment Risk Alerts • Hedge Accounting Documentation • VAR Analysis • Exposure Aggregation	• Transfer Pricing Analysis • Trade Finance & Compliance Screening • Fraud Management • Credit Risk Scoring • Hedge Execution & Monitoring	• Hedging Strategy
Capital Markets	• Trade Confirmations • Covenant Compliance Monitoring	• Re-financing Opportunity Analysis • Debt Portfolio Analytics	• Repatriation Recommendations • Dividend / Buy-back Recommendation • Debt Issuance Strategy • Capital Structure Optimization

The window to act is now. Corporate treasuries should map their existing technology stack – from TMS and ERP to banking connectivity and data infrastructure – against a composable, agent-native target state. They should identify integration gaps limiting real-time visibility, evaluate where agentic AI can deliver value within existing workflows, and initiate a structured pilot – with governance guardrails and data quality standards built in from the start.

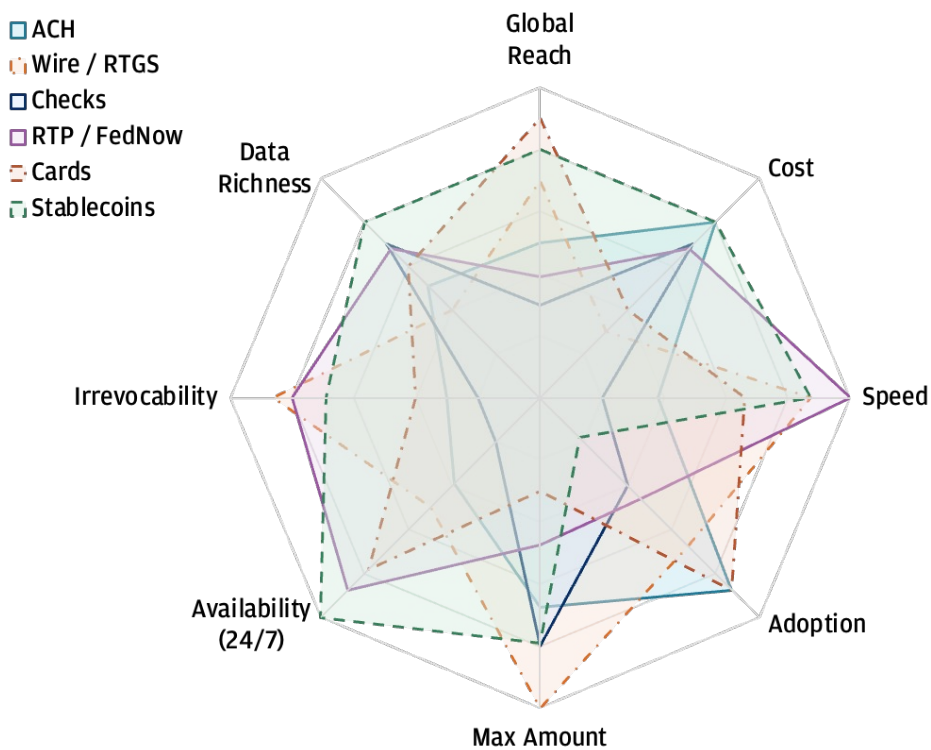
2C The Multi-Rail Payments Reality: No Single Rail Rules

Our 2025 report (Link) highlighted 300+ payment methods globally; that number continues to grow. Each channel commands a distinct advantage – and carries a corresponding trade-off – making the case for a deliberate multi-rail strategy not just compelling but inevitable.

In our experience, each of these rails is finding its natural fit over time: ACH for volume, wire for high-value finality, real-time for speed and immediacy, and cards for embedded workflows. And checks? They're in managed decline – stubborn, but fading.

Optimizing for a single rail means accepting avoidable trade-offs in cost, speed, reach, or resilience. Organizations that treat payment rail selection as a dynamic, data-driven decision – rather than a static default – will unlock measurable advantages in working capital, supplier relationships, and operational resilience. Those that don't will end up overpaying for speed they don't always need – or, worse, lacking speed precisely when they can't afford to wait.

Payment Rail Comparison



A. Analyzing B2B Payment Trends

ACH remains the undisputed backbone of U.S. B2B payments - processing 35.2 billion payments worth $93 trillion in 2025[55] – thanks to its unmatched combination of reach, cost efficiency, data richness, and ecosystem depth.

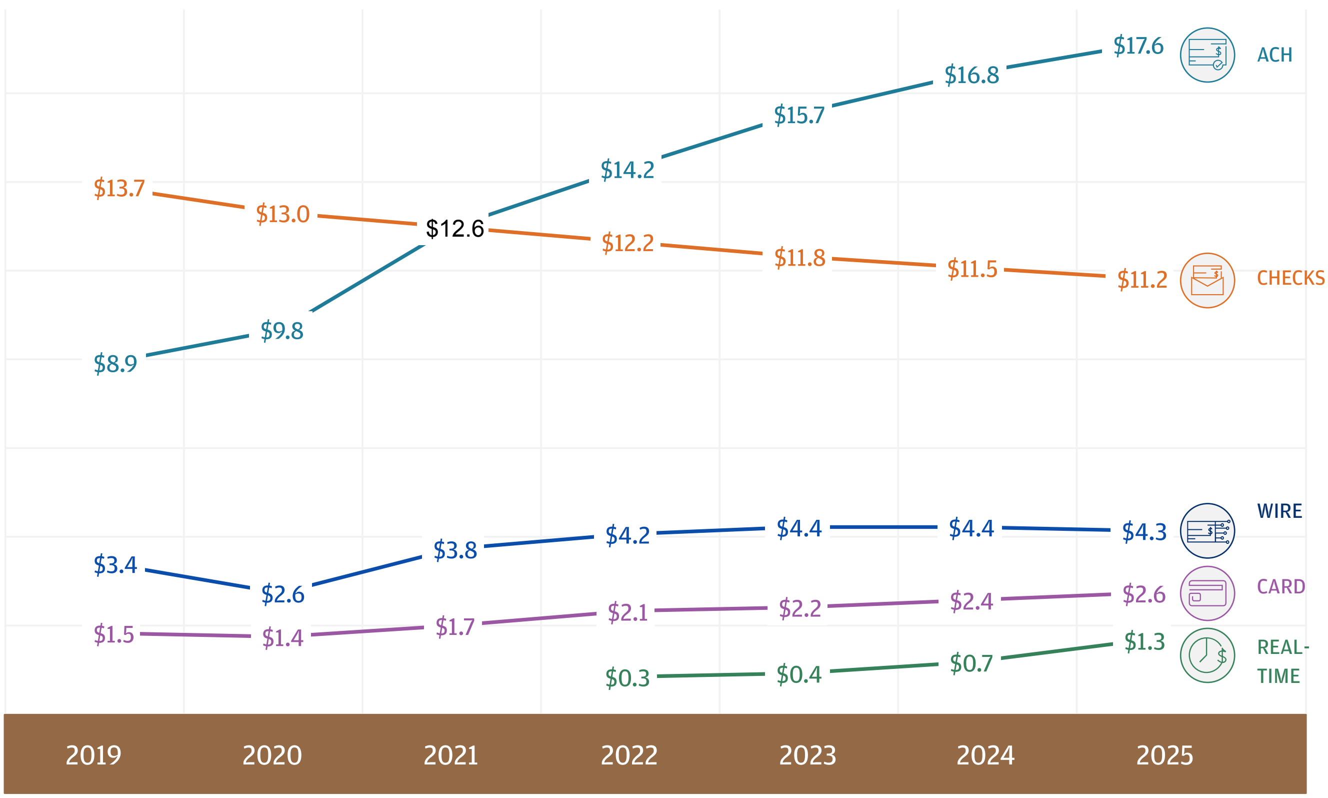
Checks are in structural, not cyclical, decline as corporates digitize AP/AR workflows – yet their stubborn persistence in healthcare, real estate, and government reveals that displacing paper is as much a process challenge as a technology one.

Wire remains essential for high-value and cross-border finality, but rising costs are forcing treasurers to deploy it surgically rather than by default.

Real-time payments are signaling modest adoption - RTP surpassed $1.3 trillion in 2025 (up from ~$246B)[56], FedNow has connected 1,700+ institutions[57], and instant payments are projected to reach 32% of global volume by 2029[58] – indicating a shift toward real-time payment adoption.

Cards are the stealth contender - Virtual cards are gaining B2B traction through automated reconciliation, rebate economics, and seamless integration into procurement and AP platforms.

US Business to Business Payment Trends ($ Trillions)



B. Analyzing E-Commerce Payment Trends

The chart below reveals not just where e-commerce payments are today – but where they might be heading. Cards still lead and remain the most universally supported payment method. It also suggests that fewer merchants are adding cards today – signaling market saturation.

Digital Wallets: The Fastest-Rising Contender

Digital wallets are now accepted by approximately 68% of merchants – and they also have the highest rate of new adoption over the past 12 months[59]. This indicates that merchants are actively prioritizing wallet acceptance.

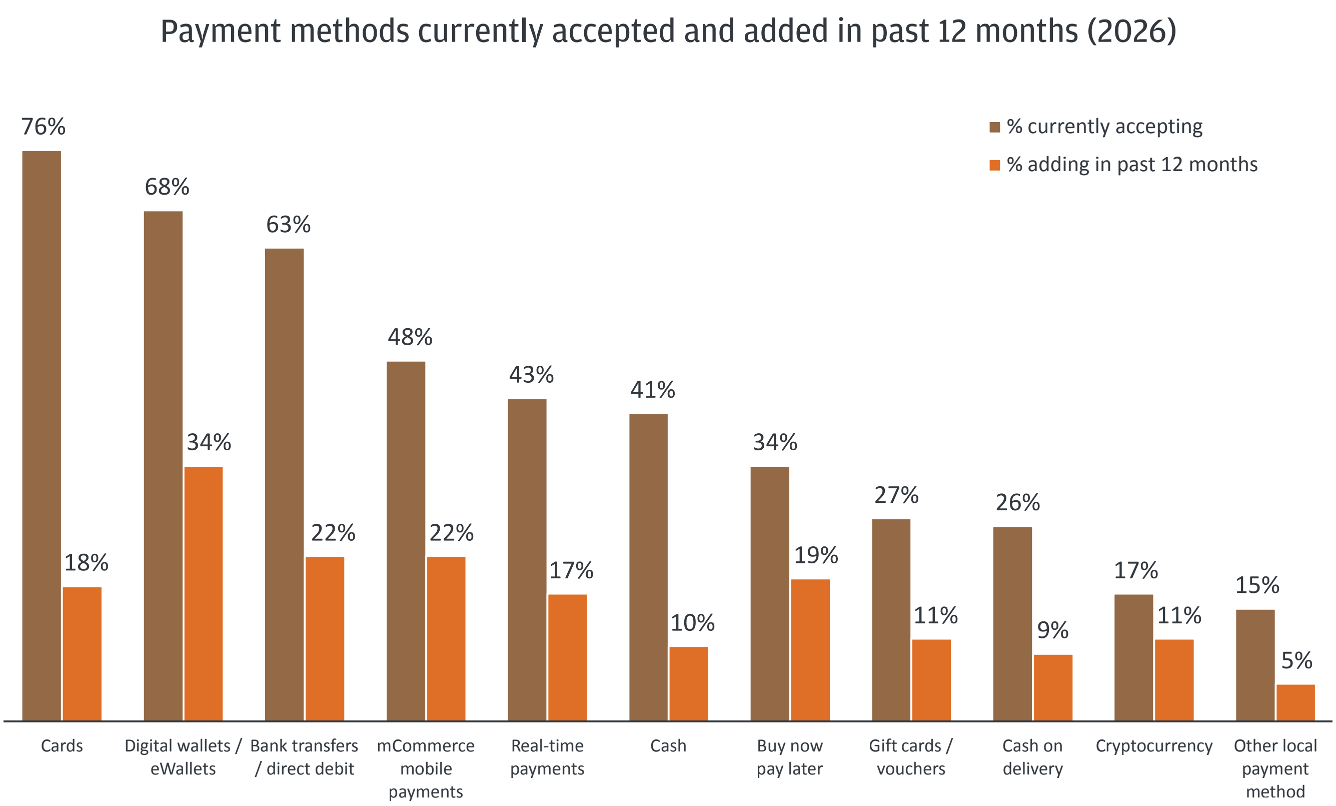
The numbers back this up at a global level: In 2025, digital wallets accounted for 56% of all online spending worldwide[60]. Regional differences are notable – Asia-Pacific leads with wallets making up 77% of online spending[60], while the U.S. remains card-dominant but is catching up fast, with wallets now representing 40% of online spending[60].

Real-Time Payments & BNPL: Rising Adoption

Merchants today accept four to five payment methods on average, with cards, digital wallets, and bank transfers leading at over 60% acceptance globally, followed by mCommerce (48%) and real-time payments (43%) – the latter seeing significant year-on-year growth that now places it above cash in the top five[59].

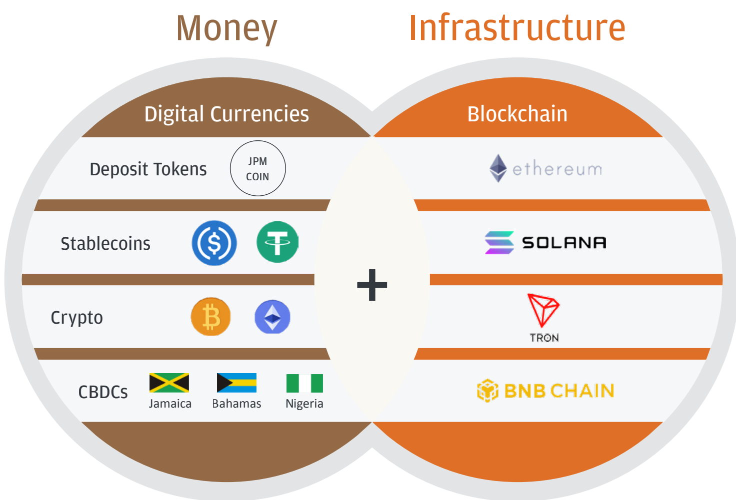
Both real-time payments and BNPL have moved well past the experimental stage. Real-time payments are accelerating through infrastructure buildout (FedNow, RTP), while BNPL is expanding beyond retail into healthcare, automotive, and services.

Payment Acceptance



2D Digital Currency and Tokenization: Past the Hype Cycle, Not Yet Past the Litmus Test

The digital currency landscape has reached an inflection point that treasuries can no longer ignore. It is shifting from pilots to production.



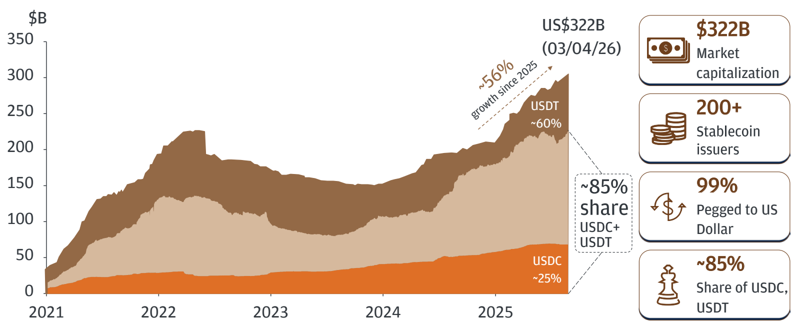
Four distinct forms of digital money – stablecoins, deposit tokens, CBDCs, and cryptocurrencies – are evolving with blockchain infrastructure to reshape how value moves globally. Each carries distinct implications for treasury, and none can be dismissed.

A. Deposit Tokens: The Regulated Bridge Between Old and New

Among the most consequential developments for corporate treasury is the emergence of bank-issued deposit tokens. For example, Kinexys by J.P. Morgan recently launched its deposit token (JPM Coin) and is available to its eligible clients on public blockchains, starting with Coinbase's Base (Ethereum Layer-2) and being expanded to additional blockchains such as the Canton Network – marking a decisive move from pilot to production.

These tokens are bank-issued deposit liabilities, operate within existing compliance and regulatory frameworks, and can be treated as traditional deposits on institutional balance sheets.

Stablecoins Market Capitalization Growth



Source Defillama

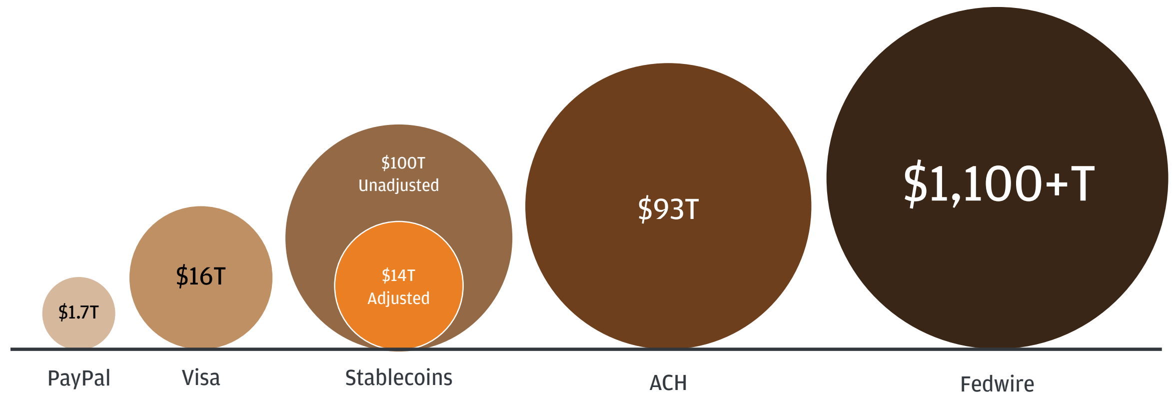
B. Stablecoins: $320+ Billion and Growing – But Read the Fine Print

The headline numbers are staggering. Stablecoin market capitalization reached $322 billion by May 2026[11], reflecting more than 50% growth since early 2025. The market is dominated by two players – USDT (~60% share) and USDC (~25% share), together commanding ~85% of the market[61]. There are now over 200 stablecoin issuers, with 99% of stablecoins pegged to the US dollar[62].

Transaction volumes have surged in parallel – unadjusted stablecoin volumes reached $79 trillion over the last 12 months[63], placing them nominally between Visa and ACH.

But look closer and the picture gets more nuanced. Strip out crypto trade settlement – which accounts for the vast majority of stablecoin flows – and the volume relevant to real-economy payments shrinks dramatically. This distinction matters enormously for treasury leaders: the stablecoin rails are proven for speed and throughput, but the commercial payment use case is still emerging, not yet dominant. Most of what moves through stablecoins today is crypto-trade activity – not corporate payables, receivables, or cross-border trade settlement.

Stablecoins Transaction Volume (LTM)[63, 64]



*Size of the circle is not correlated to the size of transactions

C. The Corporate Treasury Litmus Test

For any form of digital currency to scale within corporate treasury operations, it must pass a demanding litmus test across multiple dimensions. Until these boxes are checked – comprehensively and consistently across jurisdictions – digital currencies may remain a strategic watching brief for most corporate treasuries, not a core operational rail.

Key Considerations for Treasury Adoption

COST	• **Off-ramping and FX costs** involved • Regulatory, Governance, AML/KYC, Fraud prevention cost yet to fully play out
KYC/AML	• **Regulatory Guidance** on KYC requirements for digital currency holders • Wallet identification & **validation infrastructure**
PRIVACY	• On-chain transactions privacy layer solutions • Commercial secrecy and data protection challenges for **regulated industries**
INTEROPERABILITY	• Multiple blockchains networks & token issuers. **Market making at a nascent stage** • **Consumer friction** with different companies using different digital tokens
INTEGRATION	• Seamless integration of Blockchain platforms with **ERP / TMS** • **Reporting and reconciliation** process alignment with traditional finance platforms
TAX & ACCOUNTING	• Clarity on **Tax treatment of change in value,** WHT handling • Clear accounting treatment under US GAAP & IFRS
REGULATIONS	• **Broader acceptance** of digital currency across global markets & uniformity in treatment • Compliance with existing **cross-border regulations**

D. The Road Ahead: Three Catalysts That Could Change the Calculus

Despite these hurdles, the landscape is evolving rapidly, and three converging forces have the potential to tip digital currencies from pilot to mainstream treasury relevance:

I. Scaling Pilots into Production.

Multiple deposit token and blockchain payment pilots – including intercompany payments, commercial settlements, time-critical transfers, collateral management, and T+0 trade settlement – are being tested and refined.

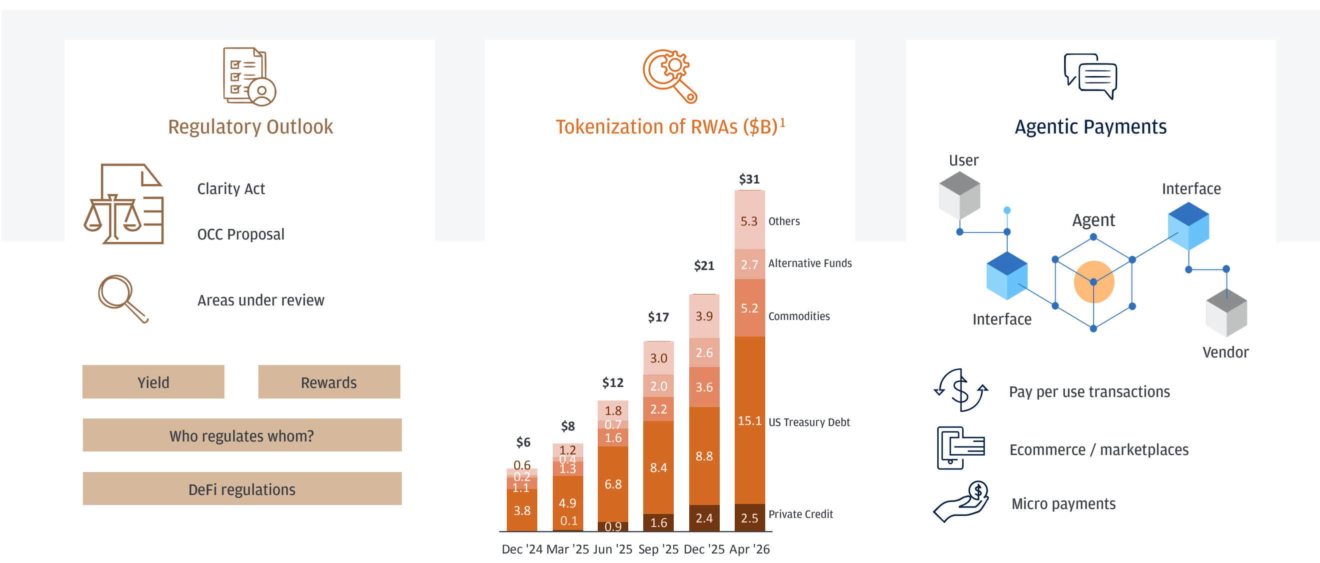
II. Real-World Asset (RWA) Tokenization Demands Digital Currency Settlement.

The tokenization of real-world assets has surged from $6 billion in December 2024 to $31 billion by April 2026[8], spanning US Treasury debt, private credit, commodities, and alternative funds. Institutions like JPMorgan, BlackRock, Goldman Sachs and BNY Mellon have all launched tokenized product offerings. As tokenized assets scale, they will require native digital settlement – and stablecoins and deposit tokens could become natural settlement currencies. This may create a powerful demand flywheel: more tokenized assets - more demand for stablecoin/deposit token settlement - more infrastructure investment - more tokenized assets.

III. Agentic Payments: AI Agents Will Need Programmable Money.

Agentic commerce – where AI agents autonomously discover, negotiate, and pay for goods and services – requires programmable, instant, 24/7 money that can execute conditional logic – precisely the characteristics that digital currencies provide. As agentic AI proliferates across e-commerce, marketplaces, and micropayments, it may become a compelling demand driver for digital currency adoption.

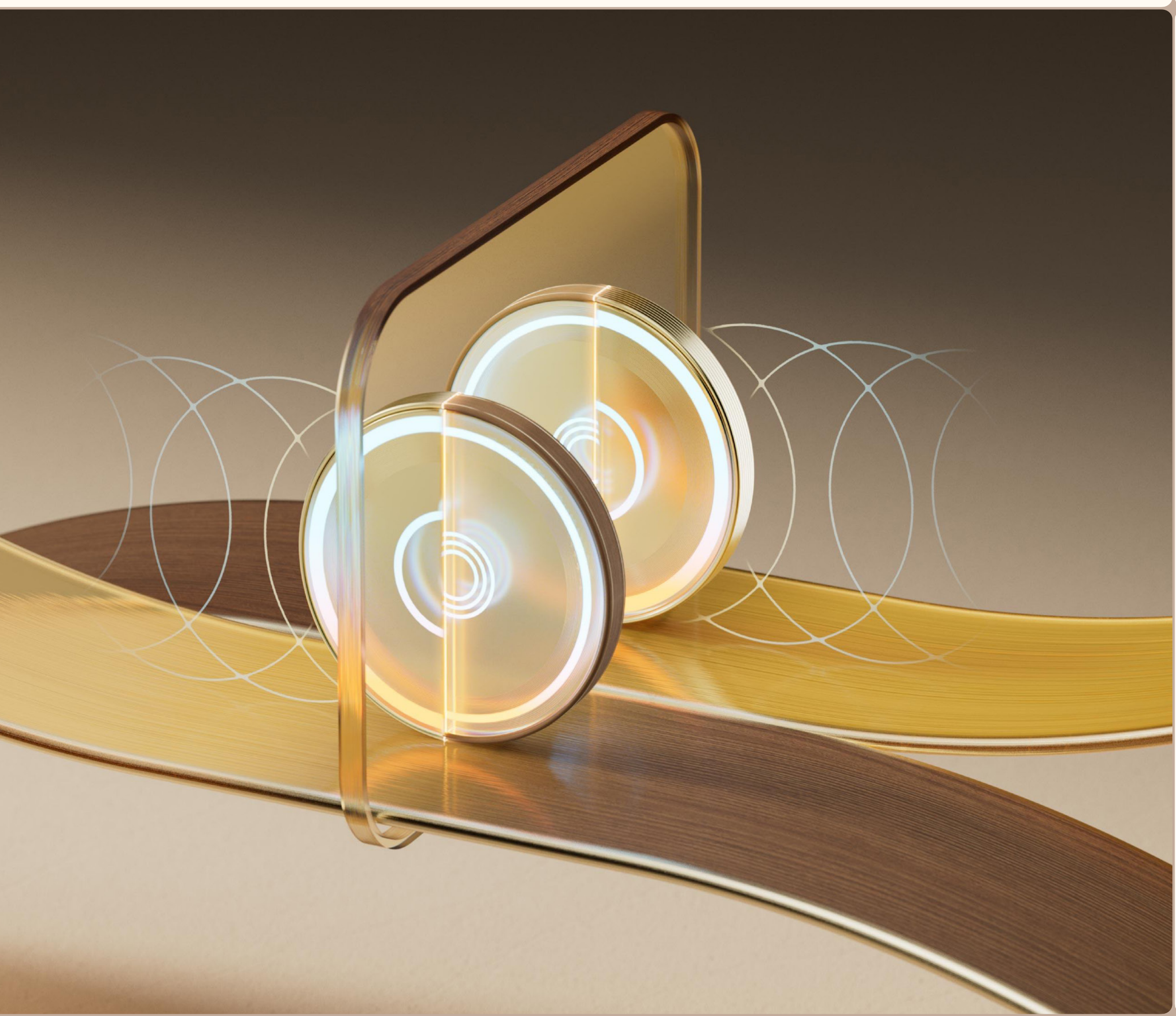
Road Ahead



Tokenization and digital currencies are no longer a technology experiment – they are an emerging financial architecture. The market capitalization and volume numbers are real, but the commercial use cases are still catching up. The treasurers who engage now, even cautiously, will be best positioned when these pilots become rails.

03

Intelligence: The Next Frontier



3A The Polycrisis Is the New Normal – And Treasury Must Treat It as Such

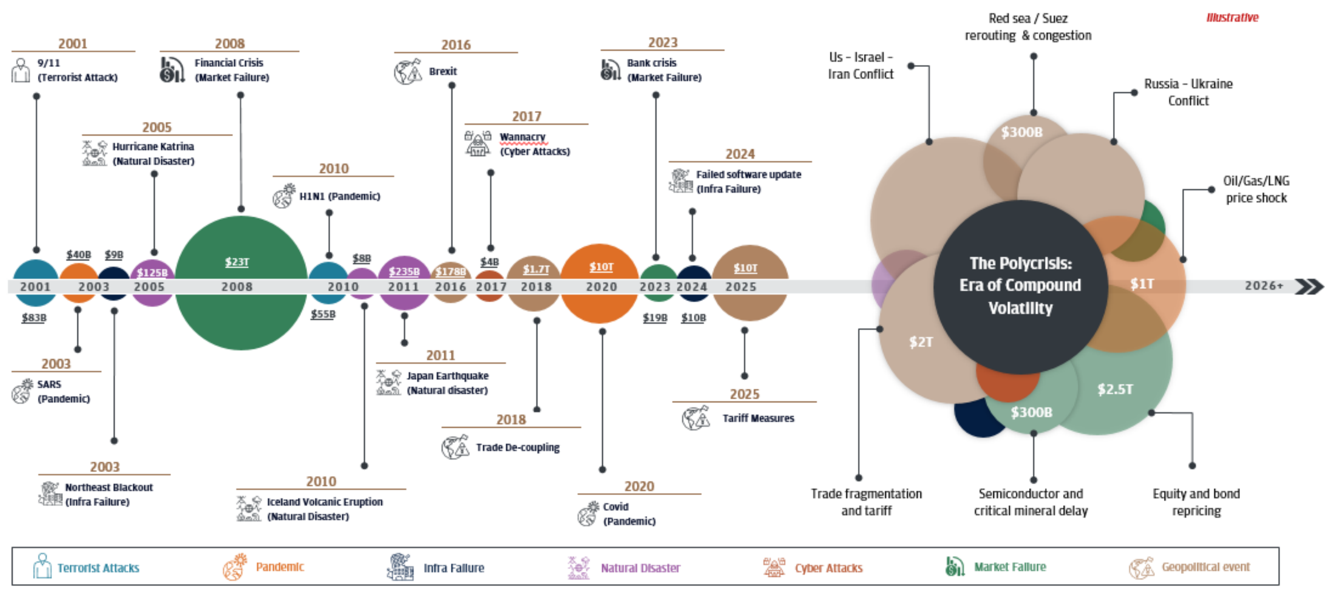
Treasuries have always been in the business of managing risk. But the operating assumption that disruptions arrive one at a time, with recovery intervals in between, is no longer valid. The timeline tells a sobering story: since 2001, various disruptions – terrorist attacks, pandemics, financial crises, natural disasters, cyber attacks, infrastructure failures, and geopolitical events – have wiped out trillions in market capitalization for corporates. The progression is not just a list of events – it is a pattern of accelerating frequency and compounding intensity.

But the defining feature of the current era – what the chart captures as "The Polycrisis: Era of Compound Volatility" – is that these shocks are no longer sequential. They are simultaneous.

The data confirms this shift in behavior: 88% of corporate treasurers now indicate moderate-to-high concern over geopolitical risk, with 68% citing "high concern" following Middle East escalation, prompting a flight to safer liquidity instruments[65].

Uncertainty No Longer an Outlier but a Baseline

Various disruptions since 2001 and have wiped off more than ~$62T in market capital for corporates



Structural Implications for Treasury

- **Continuous scenario planning to replace static models:** Traditional quarterly planning models are inadequate. The rapid pace and interconnected nature of shocks demand continuous, trigger-based scenario planning — an approach that enables teams to quickly test assumptions, prioritize exposures, and make urgent decisions as conditions evolve.

- **Resilience no longer depends on capital strength alone:** It depends on decision speed, adaptive frameworks, and the ability to absorb change in real time. The strongest organizations are those that engineer resilience during stability — not improvise it during crisis.

- **Global liquidity structures must be prepositioned — not assembled in a crisis:** When compound shocks hit simultaneously across geographies, the ability to move liquidity rapidly and fund different parts of the business — whether to shore up a supply chain in Asia, cover margin calls in Europe, or backstop operations in the Middle East — becomes a decisive competitive advantage. Treasuries that wait until a crisis to build cross-border cash pooling, account rationalization, intercompany lending frameworks, or multi-currency credit facilities will find themselves trapped by the very disruptions they need to respond to.

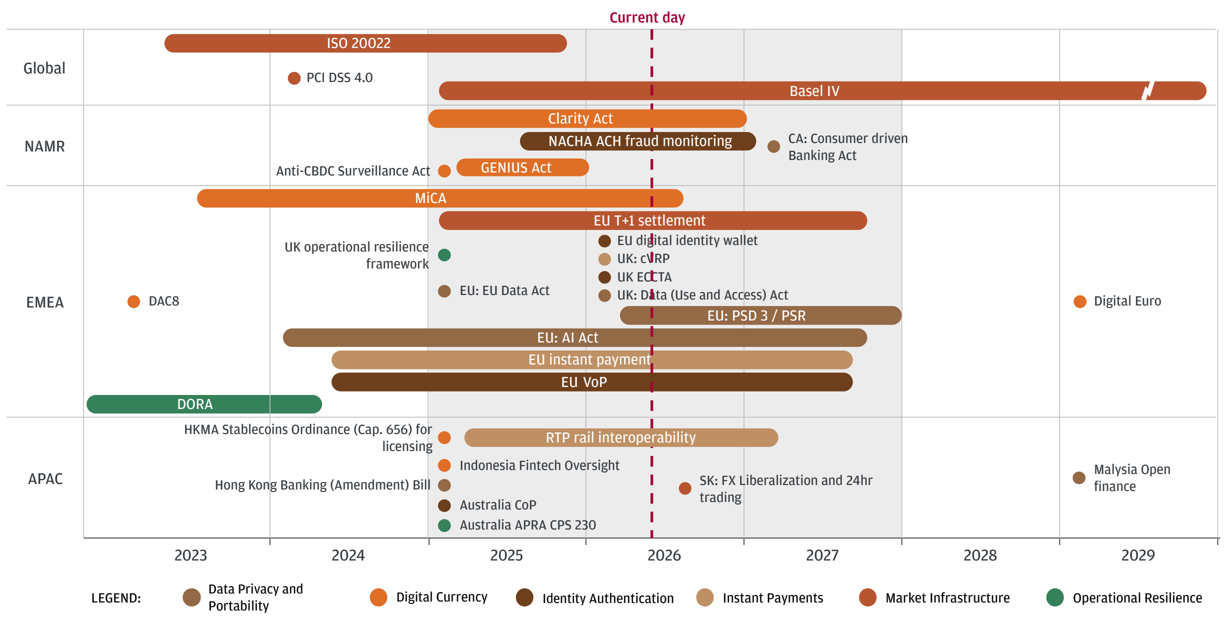
- **Underestimated impact on working capital:** This is the hidden cost of compound volatility that rarely makes the headlines but hits the balance sheet hard. When geopolitical shocks disrupt supply chains, the cascading effects are predictable: transit times elongate, forcing companies to hold higher safety-stock inventories; suppliers tighten credit terms as their own liquidity comes under strain; customers delay payments as uncertainty spreads. Companies that proactively manage their liquidity buffers — using early supplier payment programs, virtual cards, and flexible funding structures — will free up capital even under stress — while those running lean buffers calibrated to benign conditions, risk finding themselves cash-constrained precisely when agility matters most.

3B Regulatory Intelligence: From Reactive Compliance to Strategic Foresight

The regulatory landscape facing treasury and payments is not just expanding – it is converging across multiple domains simultaneously, creating a complex, multi-jurisdictional web that demands proactive intelligence rather than reactive compliance.

The chart maps an unprecedented density of regulatory activity across Global, NAMR, EMEA, and APAC from 2023 through 2029 facing treasuries right now.

Regulatory Intelligence



Globally, ISO 20022 – mandatory by November 2026 – is driving a foundational shift from fragmented manual workflows to structured, interoperable data models. Yet over half of payments firms remain only partially compliant, and 67% of errors are attributed to data quality issues[67]. Basel IV is rolling out through 2028, recalibrating capital requirements and risk weights with direct implications for how banks manage liquidity and payments.

In North America, the GENIUS Act (stablecoins), CLARITY Act (digital assets), and Anti-CBDC Surveillance Act are reshaping the digital currency framework, while NACHA fraud monitoring requirements tighten payment controls.

In EMEA, the simultaneous rollout of MiCA (digital currency), EU T+1 settlement, PSD3/PSR (payments overhaul), the EU AI Act, EU instant payments mandate, DORA (operational resilience), and the Digital Euro initiative creates a regulatory density unlike anything treasury teams have previously faced. PSD3/PSR alone introduces harmonized fraud prevention rules, IBAN-Name Check, stricter liability, and mandatory open banking standards.

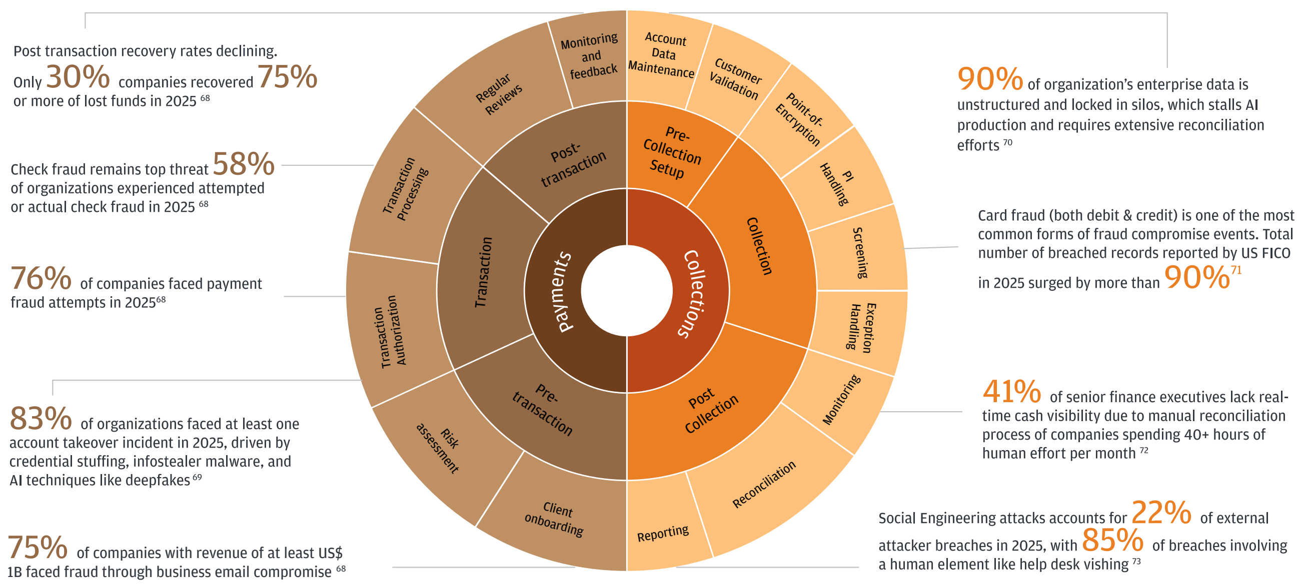
In APAC, HKMA stablecoin licensing, RTP rail interoperability initiatives, South Korea's FX liberalization, Indonesia fintech oversight, and Malaysia's open finance push are adding further layers of complexity.

Regulatory intelligence is no longer a compliance exercise. Treasuries that invest in mapping, monitoring, and scenario planning against this regulatory horizon will gain lead time on operational adaptation, product strategy, and competitive positioning.

3C Payment Fraud: The Flywheel That's Growing Faster Than Defenses

The Payments Control Flywheel for companies illustrates key stages of its business lifecycle – from client onboarding and risk assessment through transaction processing, receivables, reconciliation, and monitoring – and the fraud pressure points at each stage. The numbers are alarming, and the flywheel is getting bigger, faster, and more complex.

Payment Control Flywheel



AI has fundamentally changed the threat landscape. Phishing reports surged dramatically in early 2025, driven largely by AI-generated phishing kits. At the same time, deepfake video and voice-cloning technology, which now requires only a few seconds of audio, is being used to impersonate executives in real-time video calls, with one notable example being the Arup deepfake incident, which resulted in significant financial losses. Looking ahead, generative AI-facilitated fraud losses in the United States alone are projected to reach tens of billions of dollars within the next few years.

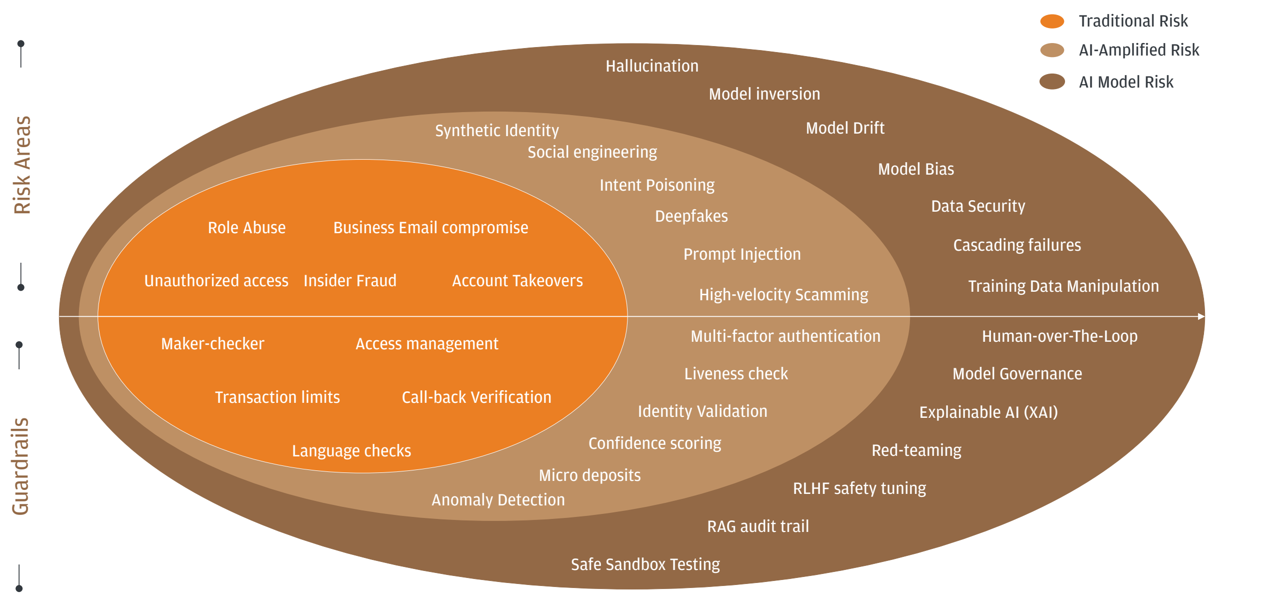
The problem extends across the entire flywheel.

Key Threat	Stage	Scale of Problem
Master Data Integrity	Master Data	90% of organizations' enterprise data is unstructured and locked in silos, which stalls AI production and requires extensive reconciliation efforts[69]
Card fraud & identity theft	Receivables / Identity	Breached records reported by US FICO on card fraud surged by more than 90% in 2025[70]
Manual processes	Reconciliation	52% of mid-sized firms manually gather/consolidate forecasting data[71] 41% of senior finance executives lack real-time cash visibility due to manual reconciliation processes[72]
BEC / Wire fraud	Transaction Processing	76% of companies faced payment fraud attempts in 2025[67]
Account takeover	Pre-Transaction / Risk	83% of organizations faced at least one account takeover incident in 2025[68]
Business email compromise	Client Onboarding	75% of companies with revenue of at least US$1 billion faced fraud through business email compromise[67]
Help desk manipulation	Monitoring / Social Engineering	22% of external attacker breaches in 2025, with 85% of breaches involving a human element[73]
Check Fraud	Check Processing	58% of organizations experienced attempted or actual check fraud[67]

Layered Risks Will Require Layered Controls

Corporate treasury departments may be approaching their own Skynet moment. Not the civilization-ending kind (we hope), but the philosophical one: the very technology being deployed to manage risk is simultaneously creating entirely new categories of risk that didn't exist eighteen months ago. The tool and the threat are the same thing. The Multilayered Risks and Controls framework below captures this paradox – and it should sit on the desk of every CFO and treasurer navigating the AI era.

Compounding Risk and Multi-Layered Controls



Layer 1 – Traditional Risks represent the fraud and access threats treasury has battled for decades: unauthorized access, insider fraud, account takeovers, BEC, and role abuse. The corresponding guardrails – maker-checker, access management, transaction limits, call-back verification – are foundational. But with 76% of companies facing payment fraud attempts[67] and account takeover fraud surging 354%, these controls alone are no longer sufficient[74].

Layer 2 – AI-Amplified Threats are where the paradox bites. Synthetic identity fraud, deepfakes, high-velocity scamming, social engineering at scale, and intent poisoning are not incremental evolutions – they are qualitatively new attack vectors enabled by the same AI, treasury teams are adopting. The guardrails must match the sophistication: multi-factor authentication, liveness checks, identity validation, confidence scoring, anomaly detection, and micro-deposit verification. Most treasury departments are still building – not operating – this layer.

Layer 3 – AI Model Risk is the most unsettling and least addressed. It represents risks created by AI systems themselves: hallucination, model drift, model bias, training data manipulation, prompt injection, cascading failures, and data security vulnerabilities. An AI cash forecasting model that silently drifts. A fraud detection model trained on biased data. A generative AI tool that hallucinates compliance language. These demand fundamentally different controls: human-over-the-loop governance, model governance frameworks, explainable AI, red-teaming, RLHF safety tuning, RAG audit trails, and safe sandbox testing.

For treasury leaders, this means: (1) control frameworks must expand outward as technology adoption does; (2) the human-over-the-loop principle is non-negotiable for material treasury decisions – the speed advantage of full automation is not worth the catastrophic downside of an unchecked hallucination in a payment workflow; and (3) treasury should look to have a seat at the enterprise AI governance table, because the risk tolerance for AI failure in payments is functionally zero.

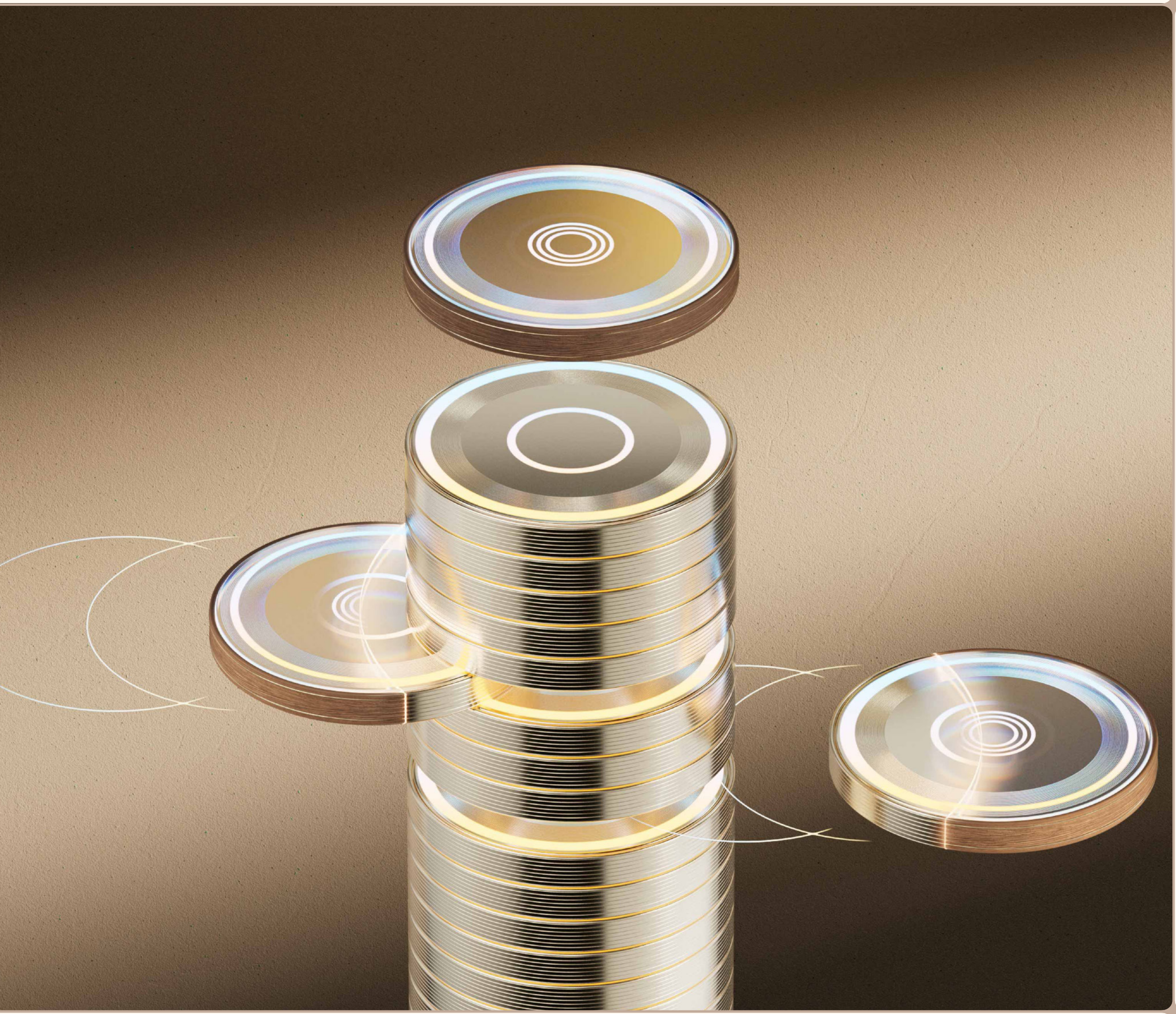
The Intelligence Imperative: Connect the Three Dots

Compound volatility, regulatory density, and AI-amplified fraud are not separate challenges. They are interconnected. Geopolitical shocks create the chaos that fraudsters exploit. Regulatory responses to fraud and instability create new compliance obligations. And the same AI that powers fraud is also the most promising tool for detecting it – if deployed with the right governance and speed.

The era of managing risks in silos is over. The Polycrisis demands Poly Intelligence. The treasuries that will thrive in this environment are those that build an intelligence function – not just risk management, not just compliance, but a connected capability that continuously monitors the geopolitical, regulatory, and threat landscape, translates signals into actionable foresight, and feeds that intelligence into operational decision-making in real time.

04

Talent: Pillar on Which Every Other Transformation Rests

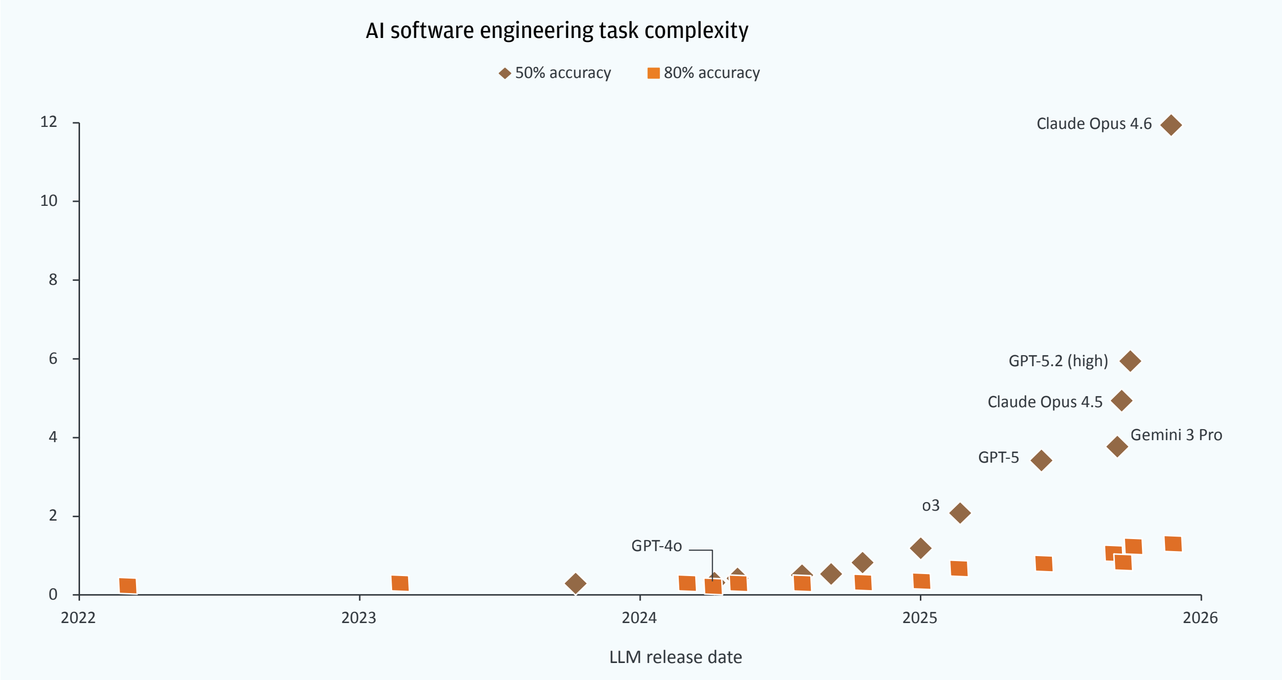


The treasury talent landscape is being reshaped by three simultaneous forces: an acute shortage of qualified professionals, rapid AI capability advancement, and a demographic shift. The talent pillar isn't just one of treasury's transformation pillars — it is the foundation on which the others rest. Get the people strategy right, and AI becomes an accelerant. Get it wrong, and even the most sophisticated technology may fail to deliver sustainable value.

4A AI Is Advancing Fast – But Not Fast Enough to Replace Judgment

Before addressing what treasuries must do about talent, it's worth establishing what AI can — and cannot — actually do today. The METR Time Horizons 2026 data reveals a striking gap: while AI models have made dramatic leaps in software engineering task complexity at 50% accuracy (with Claude Opus 4.6 reaching a complexity score of ~11.5), the picture at 80% accuracy[75] — which is still considered unacceptable for production-grade work — is starkly different. At that threshold, even the most advanced models cluster near the bottom of the chart, barely registering meaningful complexity.

At 80% Accuracy, Which is Still Unacceptable, the Picture is Quite Different...



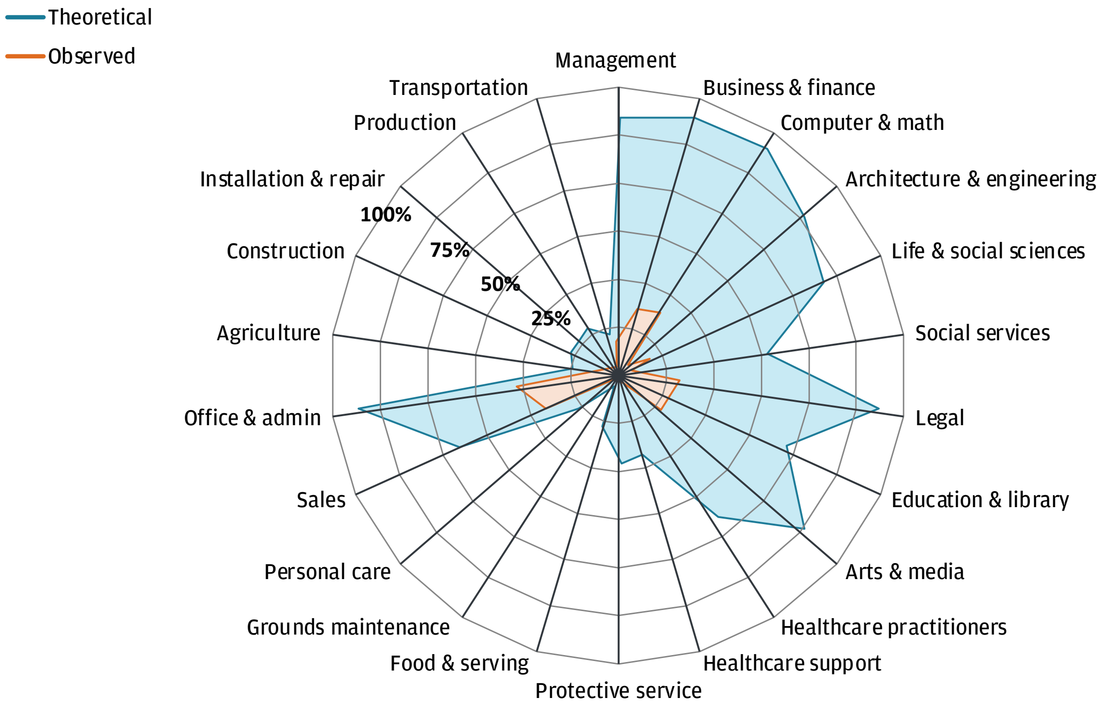
Source: METR - Time Horizons 2026

Immediate and Practical Implications for Treasury

AI can assist, accelerate, and augment — but it cannot yet be trusted to autonomously execute the nuanced, judgment-intensive work that defines treasury operations.

The Anthropic Labor Market Impacts 2026 radar chart[76] reinforces this. The observed share of job tasks AI can actually perform today — as opposed to the theoretical maximum — remains remarkably wide across virtually every occupation category, including business & finance and management. The theoretical frontier is wide, but the practical reality is thin. AI's capability envelope is expanding, but the gap between "can do in a demo" and "can be trusted in production" remains the defining constraint for treasury leaders planning their talent strategy.

Observed vs. Theoretical share of job tasks AI can perform



Source: Anthropic - Labor Market Impacts 2026

4B The Talent Squeeze Is Already Here – And It's Getting Worse

The talent challenge isn't a future risk – it's a present crisis. According to the AFP 2025 Compensation & Benefits Survey, 67% of financial professionals[77] responsible for hiring treasury and finance staff report that finding qualified candidates is their biggest challenge – ahead of compensation pressures, retention concerns, or skills gaps.

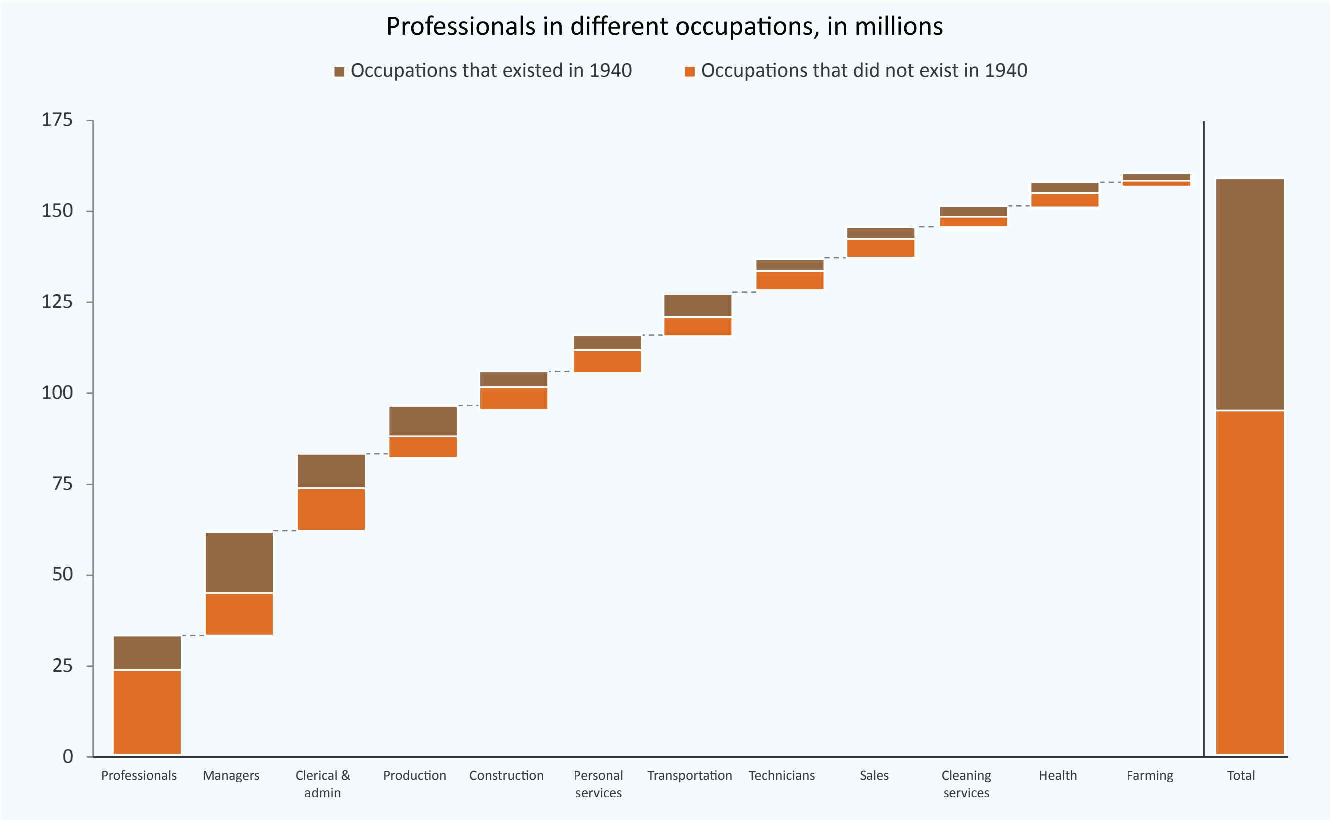
The ManpowerGroup 2026 Talent Shortage Survey confirms the pressure is economy-wide, with 72% of employers[13] reporting hiring difficulty.

But treasury faces a uniquely compounding version of this problem: the function demands specialized technical knowledge, regulatory sophistication, and cross-functional business acumen simultaneously – a combination that is extraordinarily rare in the talent market.

And it must be delivered by teams that have barely grown: the AFP Treasury Benchmarking Survey shows the average treasury team comprises nearly 12 full-time employees[20], roughly unchanged from prior years despite the dramatic expansion in scope for most treasurers. That's the productivity paradox of modern treasury in one sentence: exponentially more complexity, flat headcount, and a shrinking pipeline of qualified people who can actually do the work.

The anxiety around AI displacing treasury roles may be real but not new. Historical research offers powerful perspective: 60% of today's employment is in occupations that did not exist in 1940[78]. Across professionals, clerical & admin, construction, transportation, sales, and health, the dominant story of the past eight decades is not job destruction – it is job creation and transformation. Current projections suggest 78 million net new jobs by 2030[79], and broader research shows that even in highly automatable roles, wages are rising and job numbers are growing[80].

60% of Today's Employement in Occupations that Did Not Exist in 1940 (Millions)



Source: J.P. Morgan Eye on the Market - Smothering Heights

The treasury roles of 2030 will look materially different from those of today – but they will exist, and they will require human beings. The question is whether your organization will have cultivated them.

The Hidden Danger: Hollowing Out the Middle

The most concerning talent trend for treasury leaders isn't the skills gap at the top – it's the potential collapse of the middle. Recent research on AI adoption finds that while 17% of respondents report workforce declines due to AI in the past year, 30% expect decreases in the next year[81].

The entry-level dimension is especially acute: recent research shows 43% of companies plan to replace roles with AI, targeting operations and the back office (58%) and entry-level positions (37%)[82]. This is a leadership pipeline crisis in slow motion. Cut entry-level hiring today, and you look efficient on paper. But five years from now, you're asking who's going to lead this function – and there's nobody in the pipeline.

4C The New Skill Stack: Domain Expertise Is Necessary But No Longer Sufficient

Our treasury skill analysis framework captures a fundamental shift that every CFO and treasurer must internalize. The traditional skills – cash management expertise, risk management (FX, interest rate), banking relationship management, regulatory/compliance knowledge, financial modeling, capital markets expertise, and credit analysis – remain essential. They are not being deprecated. But they are no longer sufficient on their own.

What is changing – and rapidly – is the expectation that treasury can articulate its value and strategic importance beyond the four walls of the treasury function. As companies launch new business initiatives – entering new markets, adopting new payment rails, embedding finance into digital products, managing tokenized assets – treasury is increasingly being asked not just to execute but to advise, shape, and influence. The ability to effectively communicate treasury's perspective to business leaders, product teams, and the C-suite is becoming a defining differentiator. The last stack of finance engineering skills are likely to become essential competencies for treasury teams to drive transformation projects.

Corporate Treasury Functions Have Evolved to Become More Complex and Strategic

Traditional → Emerging

Domain	Risk & Compliance	Strategic Acumen	Finance Engineering
• Cash management • Banking infrastructure • Financial modeling • Capital markets • Legal, tax & accounting	• Reporting & Analysis • Regulatory compliance • Operational risk management • Process automation & controls • Resiliency management	• Treasury Strategy Articulation • Stakeholder management • Cross-functional project management • Growth strategy • Advanced scenario modelling	• Agentic AI Acumen • Data analytics and visualization • Prompt Engineering • ERP / System integration • Process re-design & Transformation

The most valuable treasury professionals of the next decade will be those who combine deep functional expertise with data fluency, systems thinking, and AI literacy. This is not replacement – it is augmentation, and the market is pricing in this shift. Recent research on AI's impact on the labor market shows workers with AI skills earn an average 56% wage premium over similar roles without AI skills – up from 25% just one year prior[80].

What Treasury Leaders Must Do: Six Imperatives

Brutal Skills Audit:
Map current team capabilities against the dual-stack framework of traditional and emerging skills. Be honest about gaps – both individual and collective. The gaps will be uncomfortable. They will also be actionable.

Invest in the "Adjacent Possible:
" The most effective upskilling builds on existing strengths rather than requiring wholesale transformation. A strong cash management analyst can learn data visualization. A skilled risk manager can develop scenario modeling with AI tools.

Protect the Leadership Pipeline:
Resist cutting entry-level roles for short-term efficiency gains. Model your retirement risk – employees eligible to retire within five years – against your promotion-ready pipeline. If the ratio is unfavorable, protect entry-level hiring.

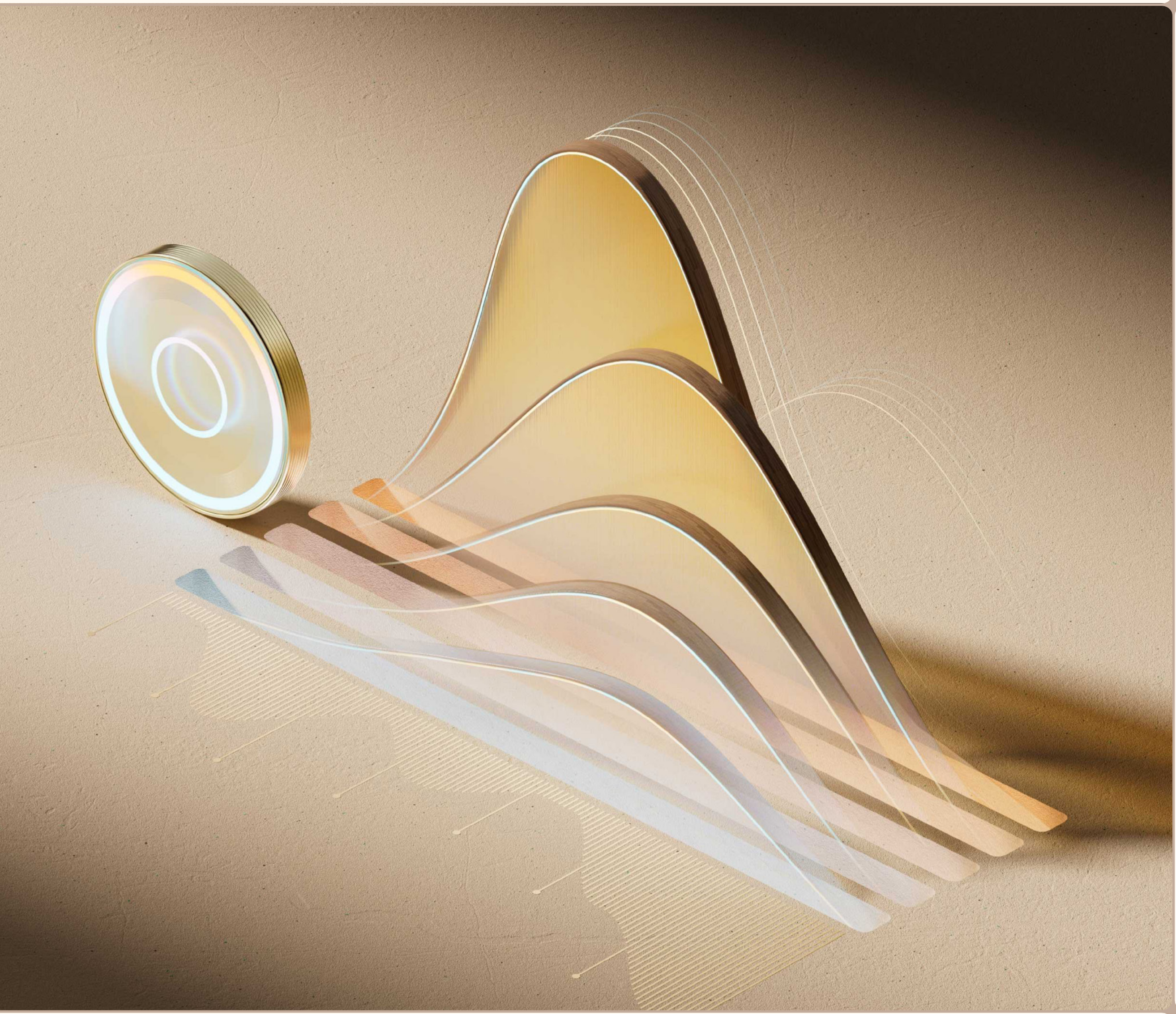
Embrace the Human-AI Hybrid:
The most productive treasury teams won't be those with the most AI or the most people – they'll be those that most effectively combine the two. Pilot AI agent integration in a controlled function – cash forecasting is a natural starting point. Explicitly design the workflow to combine AI efficiency with human judgment.

Communicate Transparently:
Your team knows change is coming – ambiguity creates more anxiety than honesty. Hold explicit conversations about AI's expected impact on your treasury function. Acknowledge uncertainty where it exists. Connect individual development plans to the organization's AI roadmap.

Measure What Matters:
Traditional treasury productivity metrics – transactions processed, reports generated – become less relevant as AI handles volume. Shift toward value-based metrics: forecast accuracy improvement, risk-adjusted returns on cash, strategic project delivery.

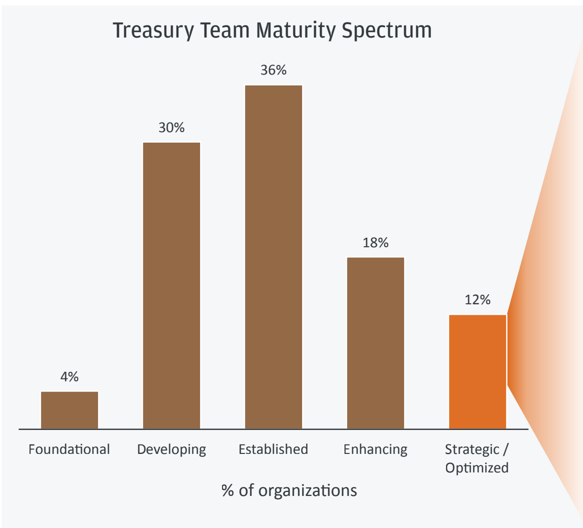
05

Strategy: The Path Forward



Most corporate treasuries are on a long-term path toward strategic value creation. According to the AFP Treasury Benchmarking Survey, only 12% of treasuries consider themselves to be truly strategic – a number that has actually declined from 17% in 2022[20]. That regression is remarkable: in a period defined by unprecedented investment in treasury technology, automation, and digitization, fewer treasury teams felt they had achieved strategic standing than four years ago.

Corporate Treasury Still Need to Build a Long Path Towards Strategic Value Creation



Strategic Corporate Treasury Functions

In-house Bank	Initial Public Offering (IPO)	Mergers & Acquisitions (M&A)
Working Capital	Forecasting	Fraud Mitigation
Supply Chain	Digital Strategy	Capital Structure

Source: 2025 AFP Treasury Benchmarking Survey Report

Technology and automation made treasury more efficient – but not less busy. Each wave freed up capacity, but that capacity was immediately consumed by new operational complexity. More bank accounts. More currencies. More payment rails. More regulatory requirements.

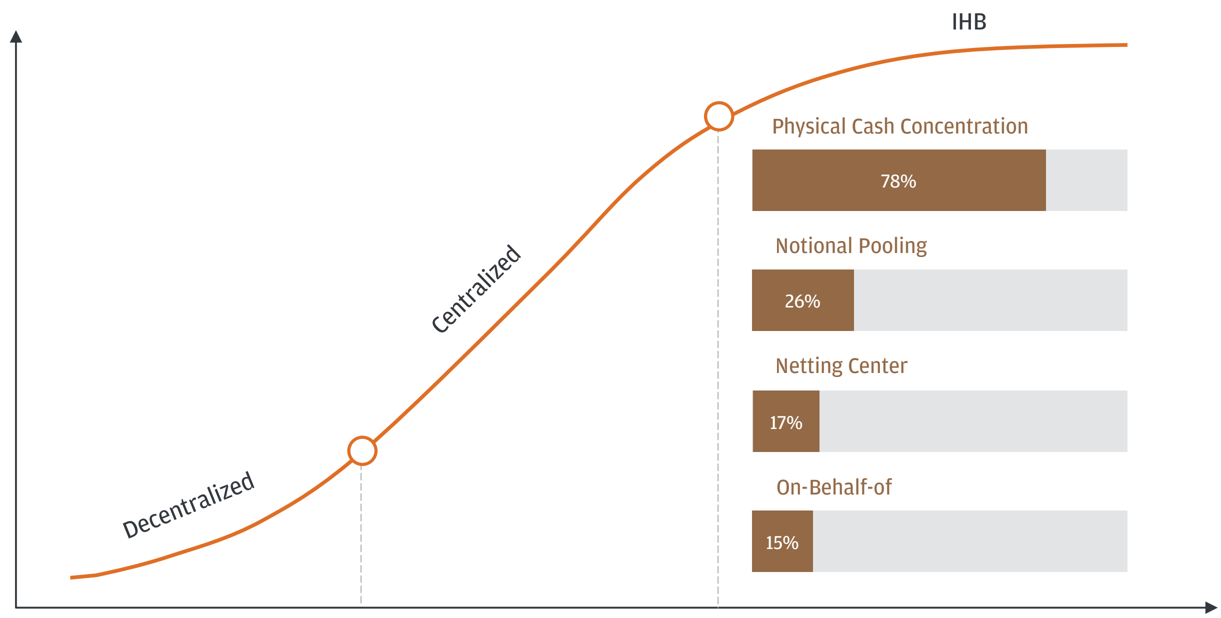
The result is a treasury landscape where organizations sit at vastly different points along the maturity spectrum – and critically, the path forward looks different depending on where you stand today. Not every treasury is starting from the same place, and not every treasury needs the same next step.

5A In-House Bank Journey Becomes a Strategic Imperative

For early-stage treasury organizations – those still managing fragmented banking relationships, decentralized payment flows, and manual liquidity processes – the priority is centralization. Consolidating bank accounts, standardizing payment execution, and building a single view of cash across entities are foundational steps that reduce operational noise and create the infrastructure on which strategic capabilities can eventually be built.

For more established treasuries, the challenge is different but equally urgent. Many of these organizations have already embarked on the in-house banking journey – but with varying degrees of sophistication. Some have implemented partial IHB structures covering select regions or functions; others have built frameworks that remain incomplete, with intercompany lending in place but FX netting or on-behalf-of payments still handled outside the IHB perimeter.

Evolution of Treasury Operating Models



Source: J.P. Morgan Payments Global Advisory Research

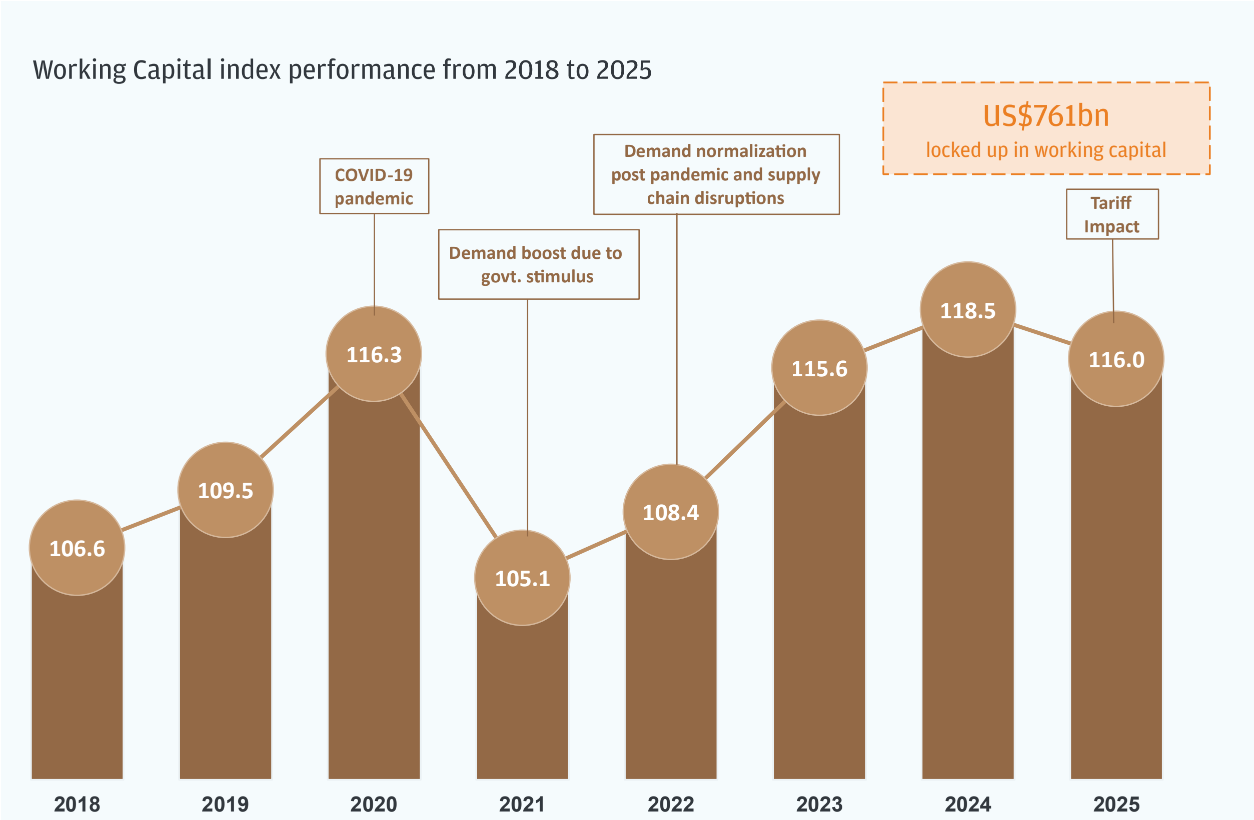
Fixing and finishing IHB setups can help create the operational capacity treasury teams need to redirect their energy toward the strategic dimensions of the business i.e., working capital optimization, M&A support, capital structure decisions, and enterprise-wide risk management etc.

5B Working Capital:
The $761 Billion Opportunity Hiding in Plain Sight

If the operating model evolution defines how treasury should be structured, working capital data makes the case for why – and why now.

The Working Capital Index has risen from 106.6 in 2018 to 116.0 in 2025 – a steady climb driven by pandemic disruption, stimulus-fueled demand surges, supply chain normalization, and now tariff-induced volatility. Each wave has pushed more cash deeper into the balance sheet, and it isn't coming back on its own

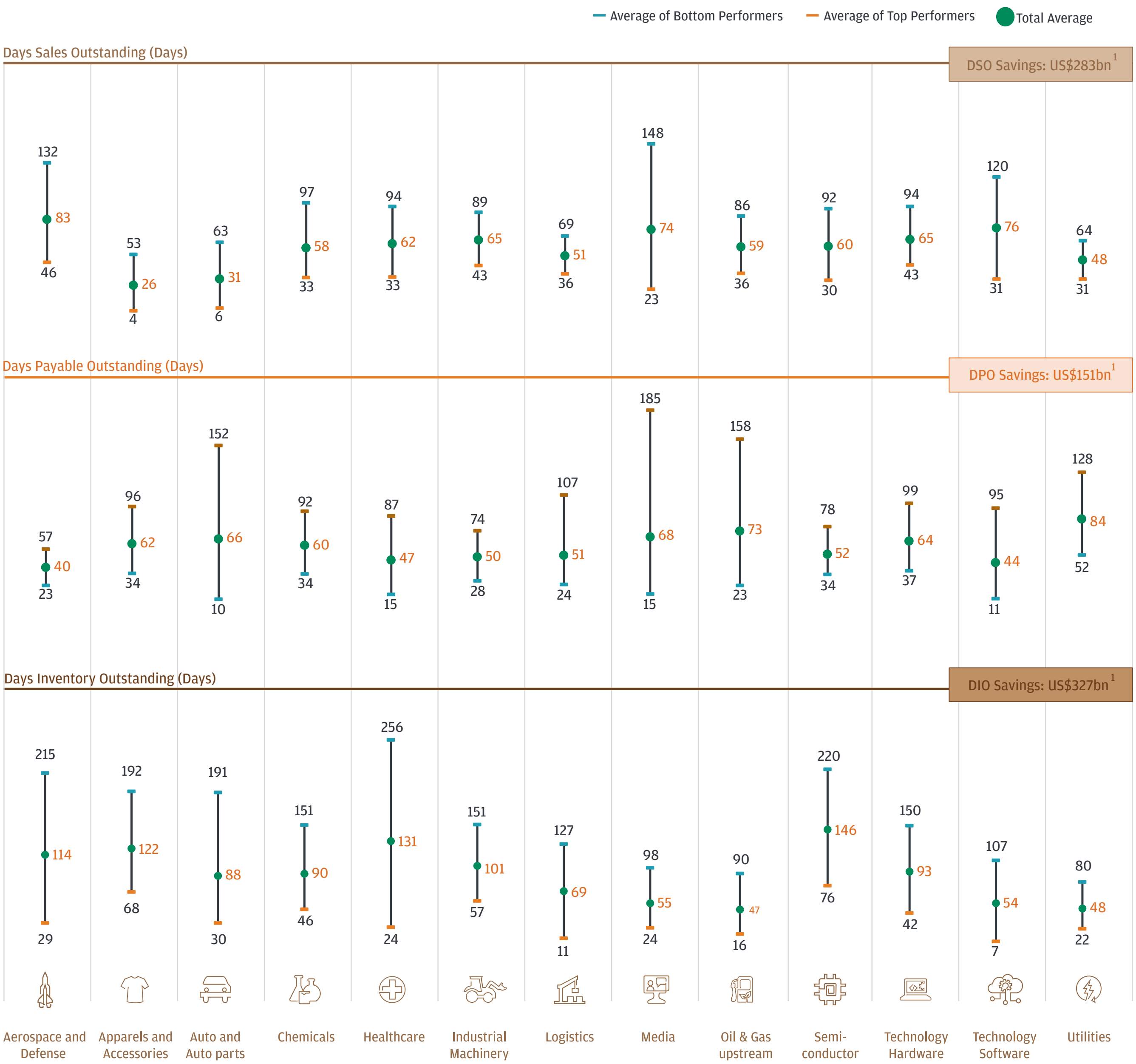
Working Capital Index



Source: Capital IQ - April 2026, J.P. Morgan Payments Global Advisory Research
Note: All years have been indexed to 2011

The cost of inaction is quantifiable. Industry benchmarking across sectors reveals wide dispersion in cash conversion cycle performance between top- and bottom-quartile companies. If every organization simply moved one quartile closer to leaders within its own industry, an estimated $761 billion in trapped working capital could be unlocked as free cash flow – up from $707 billion just two years ago. That gap isn't closing, it's widening.

Working Capital Industry Benchmarking



Source: Capital IQ - April 2026, J.P. Morgan Payments Global Advisory Research

a) DSO, DPO and DIO savings are for overall industries; b) For every working capital parameter, the companies within each industry are split into four performance quartiles (with the first quartile representing the performance of the top 25 percent companies within the industry and the fourth quartile corresponding to the bottom 25 percent). The free cash flow release calculation assumes that a company moves from its existing performance quartile to the next best performance quartile and quartile one companies remain at their current levels.

J.P.Morgan PAYMENTS

Historically, working capital belonged to operations (inventory), sales (receivables), and procurement (payables) teams. Treasury sat downstream — measuring outcomes and reporting them to the CFO. That model is obsolete. Leading treasury organizations are now stepping into the driver's seat — not as passive scorekeepers, but as active orchestrators of working capital performance. Treasury can bring the following to the table:

Cross-functional line of sight into cash
The ability to see across receivables, payables, and inventory simultaneously, connecting operational decisions to liquidity outcomes in ways siloed functions cannot.

Forecasting discipline
The rigor to model scenarios, stress-test assumptions, and quantify the cash flow trade-offs behind every working capital decision.

Banking relationships that unlock financing solutions
Access to supply chain finance platforms, dynamic discounting programs, and supplier financing structures that turn payables and receivables into strategic levers.

Risk intelligence
Real-time understanding of counterparty credit exposure across both supplier and customer portfolios, ensuring working capital optimization doesn't come at the cost of concentration or default risk.

Executive-grade dashboards
Reporting that makes working capital visible, measurable, and actionable at the leadership table, transforming it from a back-office metric into a boardroom priority.

The question is no longer whether treasury has a role in working capital — it's whether your treasury function is equipped to claim it.

5C Beyond Working Capital: Treasury's Seat at the Deal Table

Working capital is where treasury proves its strategic value – but it's not the last stop. The same capabilities that make treasury indispensable in unlocking trapped cash – cross-functional visibility, scenario modeling, banking relationships, risk intelligence – are precisely what's needed in one of the most consequential arenas of corporate strategy: mergers and acquisitions.

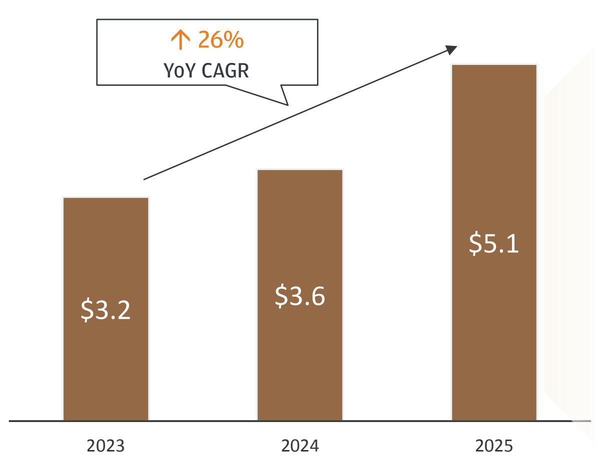
Global M&A volume reached $5.1 trillion in 2025, up 42% YoY, with mega-deals (>$10B) surging approximately 129% YoY. Cross-border M&A volumes climbed approximately 49% YoY, and Technology and Diversified Industries accounted for roughly 43% of total deal volume. The growing complexity of these transactions – larger, more global, more sector-diverse – demands treasury involvement far earlier than tradition has allowed[14].

Global M&A Activity Has Significantly Rebounded in the Past 2 Years

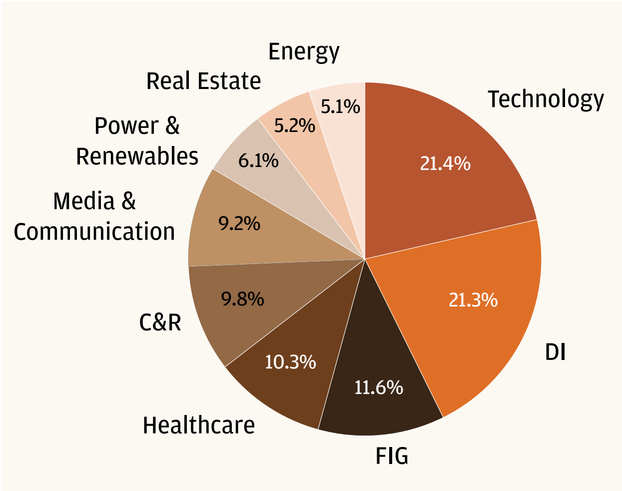
Global M&A 2025 Highlights

$5.1T	~129%	~43%
Total Volume (up 42% YoY)[1]	↑ YoY in total volume of mega-deals (>$10B)[1]	Of M&A volume driven by Tech. and Diversified Industries[1]

Global M&A Volume ($T)[1]



M&A Volume by target sector (%)[1]



Source: 2026 J.P. Morgan Global M&A Annual Outlook

Yet in most organizations, treasury remains confined to post-merger integration: rationalizing bank accounts, consolidating cash pools, and reconciling payment infrastructure after the deal is done. By that point, the most critical decisions – deal structure, funding mix, counterparty risk assessment, Day 1 liquidity architecture – have already been made without treasury's input. Value is left on the table before treasury even enters the room.

Leading organizations are rewriting this playbook. A structured Treasury Engagement Framework across the full M&A lifecycle reveals four distinct phases where treasury can – and should – drive outcomes.

Pre-Deal Closure
Early engagement in due diligence, assessing the target's cash management infrastructure, banking landscape, and liquidity profile. Treasury can also play a critical role in structuring escrow arrangements that protect deal economics.

Deal Closure
Managing purchase consideration settlement and transitional service agreements (TSAs), executing ownership changes across banking partners, and ensuring Day 1 visibility and control over cash positions from the moment the deal closes.

First 90 Days
Driving liquidity optimization, rationalizing banking and technology infrastructure, and standing up risk management frameworks for the combined entity – the window where integration momentum either accelerates or stalls.

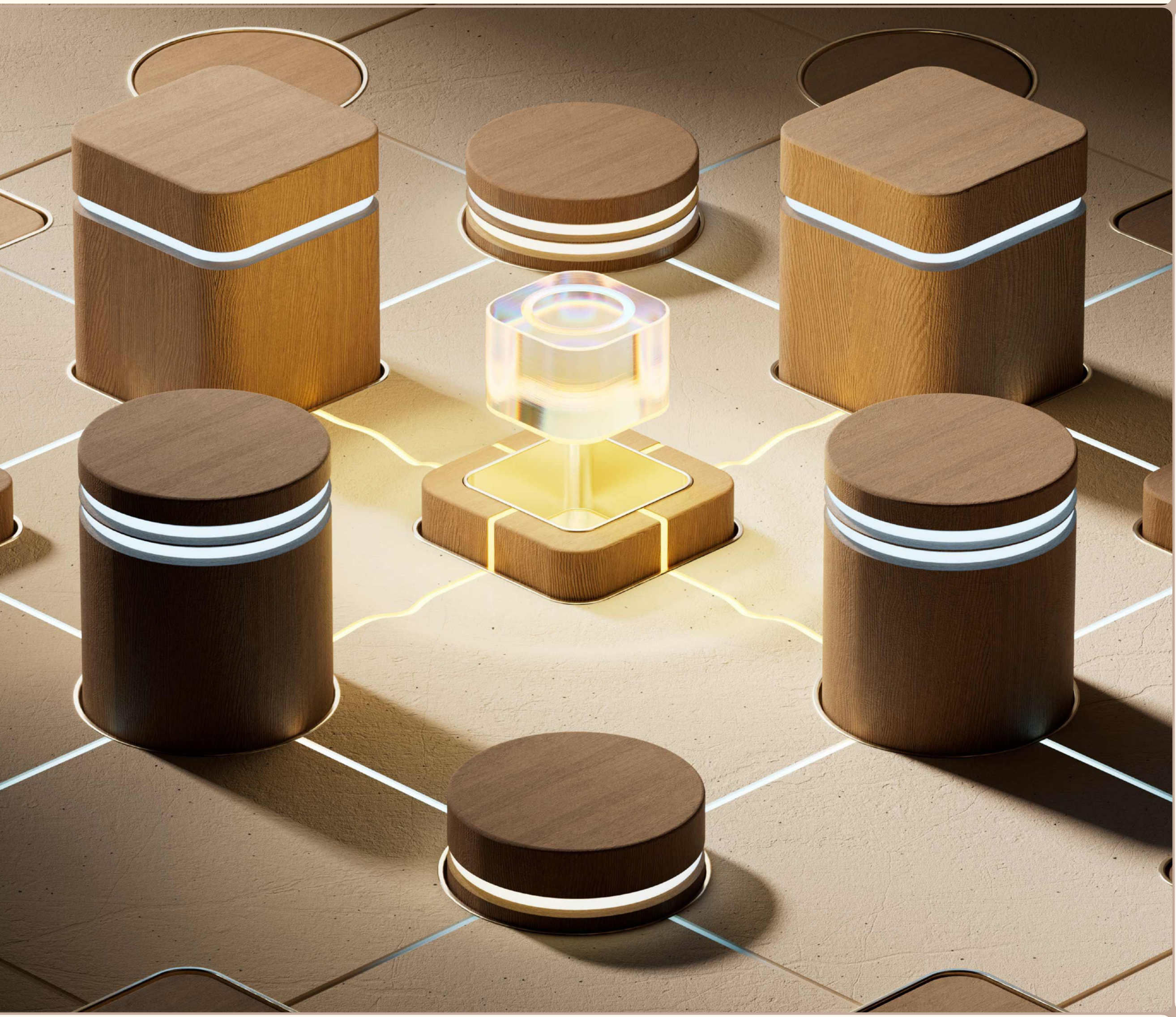
Long-Term
Designing the target operating model for the merged treasury function, capturing long-term synergies in areas like cash concentration, FX management, and financing costs, and evolving the treasury organization itself to reflect the new enterprise.

If treasury is only showing up at integration, only a fraction of the value is getting captured. The strategic treasury earns its seat at the deal table – not after the handshake, but before the term sheet.

The treasury mandate is shifting – from custodian to strategist, from cost center to value creator. Benchmark your treasury operating model against leaders, and identify where in-house banking, working capital optimization, or payment strategy can deliver measurable enterprise value – not just operational efficiency.

06

Conclusion



Conclusion

The treasury function that emerges from this period of transformation will look fundamentally different from the one that entered it. The question is not whether this transformation will happen — it's whether your organization will lead it, follow it, or be disrupted by it.

The organizations best positioned are those that recognize four things:

First, this is not a technology project: It's a strategic transformation that requires executive sponsorship, cross-functional collaboration, and a multi-year commitment. Technology is the enabler, not the objective.

Second, speed matters more than perfection: The companies deploying agentic AI in treasury today — even imperfectly — are accumulating data, developing institutional knowledge, and building competitive advantages that will compound over time. Waiting for the "right" solution is a strategy for falling behind.

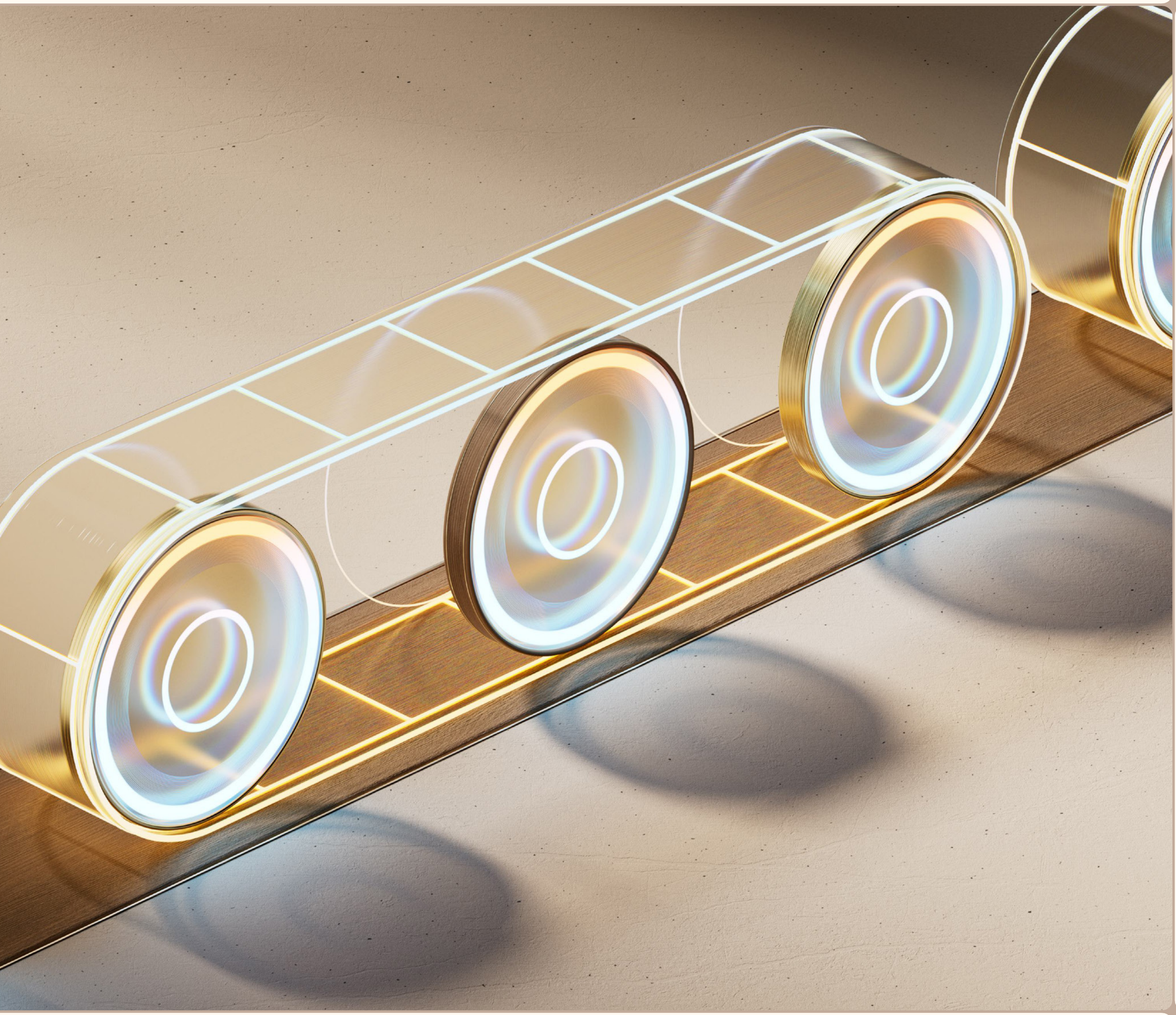
Third, people are the differentiator: In a world where every company has access to the same AI models, the same payment rails, and the same financial data, the leading organizations will be those whose treasury professionals can design the most intelligent strategies, build the most robust governance frameworks, and make sound judgement calls about when to let the machines run and when to intervene.

Fourth, risk and governance are non-negotiable: As treasury's mandate expands — the attack surface for operational, financial, and compliance risk expands with it. Every new capability treasury adopts, every automated decision it delegates, every cross-border structure it optimizes must be underpinned by a governance architecture that is as sophisticated as the capabilities it supports.

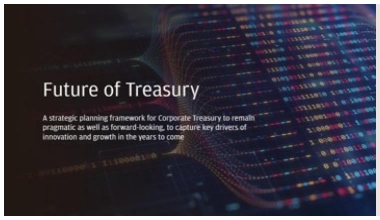
The window of competitive advantage is open now: The trends we highlighted in 2025 have played out across the industry. This report applies the same lens to the forces shaping treasury today. The question is no longer about direction — it's about pace, and whether your treasury function is moving fast enough to lead rather than follow.

07

Further Reading



Further Reading



Future of Treasury

May 2025

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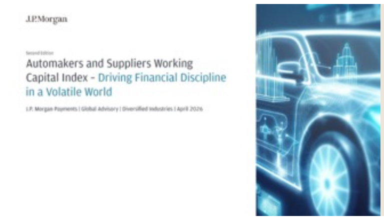

Automaker and Supplier Working Capital Index

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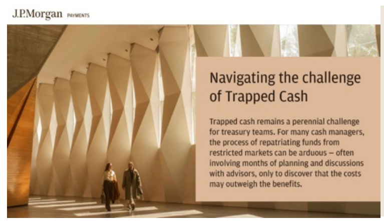

Navigating the Challenge of Trapped Cash

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Healthcare Treasury Insights 2025

November 2025

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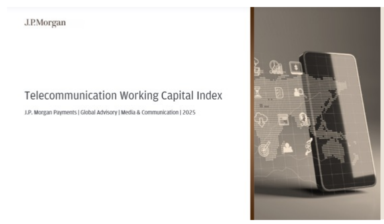

Telecommunication Working Capital Index

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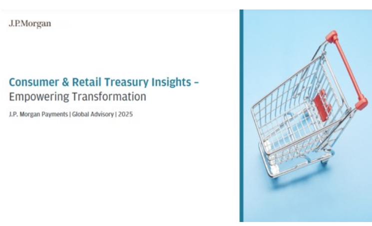

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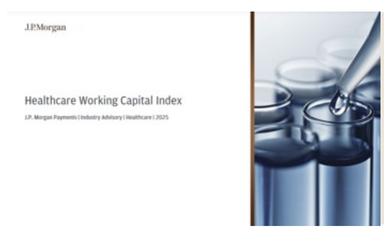

Healthcare Working capital Index

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Treasury for Scale-Ups

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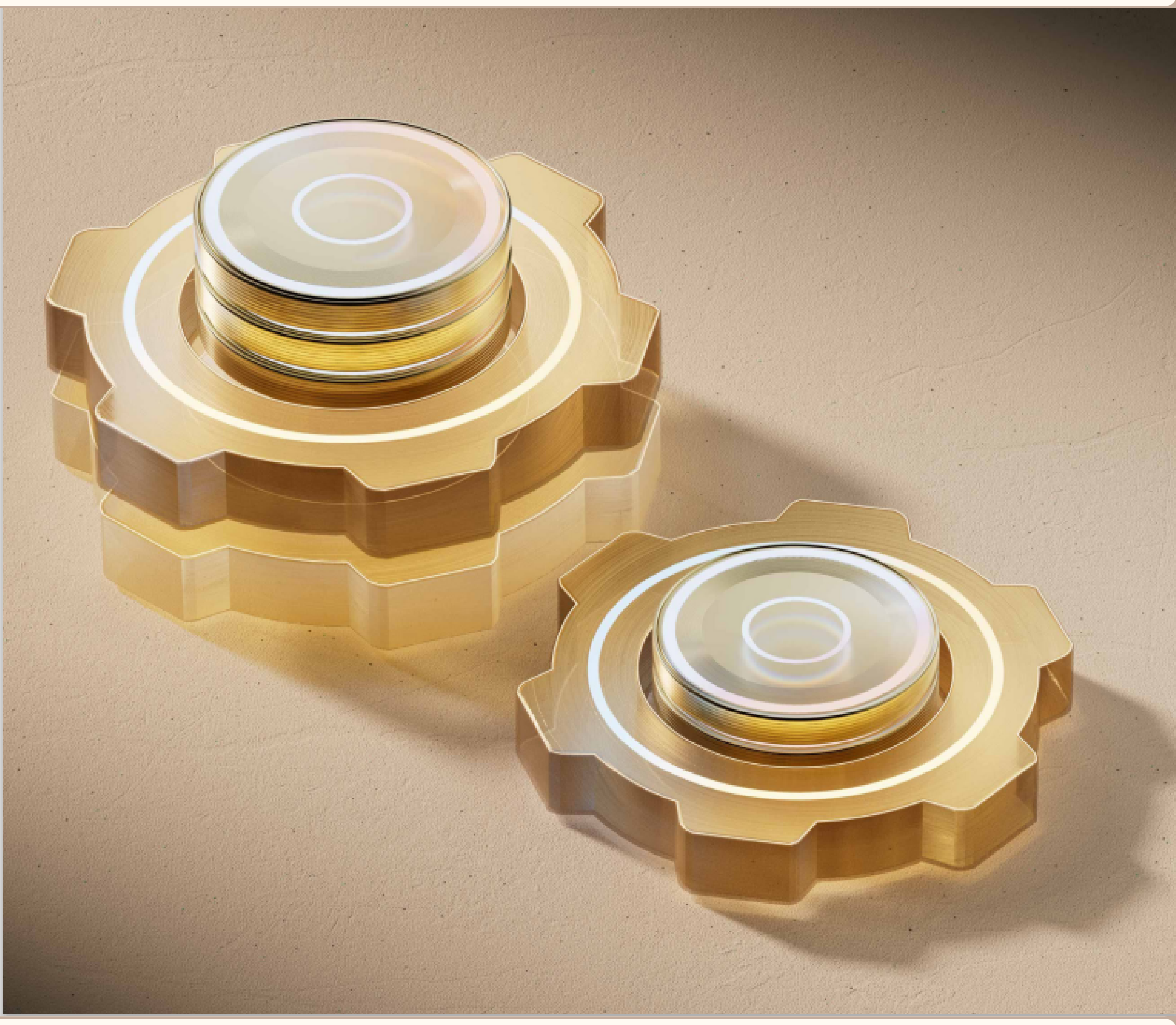

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Authors

Varoon Mandhana
Global Head of Treasury Advisory

Nirav Kakariya
N.A. Lead Treasury Advisory

Sharon Fernandes
Advisory Research & Analytics

Siddhant Khattar
Advisory Research & Analytics

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